

Advanced English (C1 Advanced)

Every workbook exercise and self-check answered, with notes on acceptable alternatives and common learner errors. Confidential teacher material.

8 modules

Exercise & quiz answers

Confidential – do not distribute

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Module 1 — Precision in Time & Modality: Answers

Answers to every Module 1 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the project briefing, the evidence-ladder verdicts and case solutions, the policy memo), and the errors you can expect to hear most.

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C3

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **accuracy, range and appropriacy**. A sentence is correct when the form is right (*by the time* + present, *have* + *pp* after a modal, the base form after a mandative trigger, *were* after inversion) **and** it expresses the exact meaning intended (in progress vs completed; *may well* vs *may as well*; real vs unreal *as if*) **and** it suits the situation. Be generous with **legitimate variants**: contractions; *might* / *could* for *may* in the "well" and "as well" structures; *should* + base as well as the bare subjunctive (typically British, fully correct); *as though* for *as if*; *was* after *suppose* / *supposing* and *if I* in informal speech (but only *were* after inversion); British spellings (*analysed*, *apologise*, *realised*). When a learner produces a correct sentence with a *different* structure from the target, accept it and point to the target: "Correct! Can you also say it with *be to*?"

1.1 • ADVANCED ASPECT — THE FUTURE IN DETAIL (C1)

◆ FIRST-DAY WRITING SAMPLE

No "answers." Score with the four-row rubric in the materials (Set B): **task & register** · **range** · **accuracy** · **organization & cohesion**, 0–3 each (max 12). Guide: 9–12 comfortable at C1 · 6–8 typical C1 entry · 5 or less: check placement privately. Give each learner a one-line private note (one strength, one focus); never a score.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE MONDAY STAND-UP (SCRIPT 1.1-A)

1	were going to reopen
2	will be working
3	will have finished
4	will have been running
5	are about to sign (<i>'re about to sign</i>)
6	is to visit
7	Will ... be needing

The project is **behind schedule**: item 1 (the April reopening was a plan that changed; it's now the end of May). Item 4 is the one to discuss: *will have been running* because the program is an ongoing activity measured by its duration up to the reopening. Item 7 is the tactful future continuous: the lead is asking about plans, not demanding a decision.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THE MOST PRECISE FUTURE FORM

- 1 will be flying (in progress at that moment)
- 2 will have completed (finished by the end of the year)
- 3 will have been running (duration up to August)
- 4 will be driving (in progress at six)
- 5 arrive · will have checked (time clause in the present; completed before)
- 6 will have known (*know* is stative: no continuous)
- 7 Will you be presenting (a tactful inquiry about plans)
- 8 will have taught (a number = a completed quantity = simple)

Wrong: 3 "will run / will have run" (loses the ongoing duration; *will have run* is marginal and implies it stops) · 5 "will arrive" in the time clause · 6 "will have been knowing" · 8 "will have been teaching more than three thousand students" (continuous + number). **Accept:** 7 "Are you presenting...?" (present continuous for an arrangement: correct, a little more direct).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE FUTURE SEEN FROM THE PAST; FORMAL FUTURES

- 1 We **were going to sign** the deal on Friday, but... (also: *were to have signed*, more formal)
- 2 I **was about to** object when she cut me off. (*was on the point of objecting* means the same, but doesn't fit the frame)
- 3 that meeting **would** change his life (also: *was to change*, more formal / literary)
- 4 The bridge **was to have opened** in 2024. (also: *was going to open* / *was supposed to open*, less formal)
- 5 The CEO **is to visit** the plant on Friday.
- 6 The two companies are **on the verge of reaching** an agreement. (also: *on the point of reaching* / *on the brink of*)
- 7 If we **are to meet** the deadline, we need two more testers.

Wrong: 4 "was to open" alone (this doesn't tell us it didn't happen; *was to have opened* does) · 6 "on the verge to reach" · 7 "If we will meet the deadline." Item 7 is useful in real briefings; praise it.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – PRECISION AND REGISTER

- 1 **Will you be using:** more tactful to a senior colleague; asks about the plan, not a decision.

- 2 **arrive:** present in a time clause.
- 3 **due to:** a scheduled date; *about to* can't take a future time phrase.
- 4 **have known:** stative verb.
- 5 **I'll be there:** casual register; "I'll have been arriving" is also ungrammatical in meaning.
- 6 **is to:** an official arrangement (formal); *about to* clashes with "next month."
- 7 **will have left:** completed before the moment of reading. (*will be leaving* is possible only if the writer is leaving at that exact moment: unlikely.)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – A FUTURE-POINT PARAGRAPH (MODEL)

The new clinic opens on September 1. On opening day, the reception team will be welcoming the first patients while the IT team will still be testing the booking system. By then, we will have moved all the patient records and trained every nurse on the new software, and the project team will have been working on the move for almost a year. We were to have opened in June, but the building inspection was delayed. The final inspection is due to take place next week, and we are on the verge of signing the cleaning contract.

Check: one form per job, a *by*-anchor for each perfect, no future in time clauses. Praise a sentence that uses *If we are to*....

◆ DIALOGUE – A PROJECT CHECK-IN

Future forms: *meets* (timetable present) · *will it be finished* · *we'll have been running* · *we'll have collected* · *were to have launched* · *were about to go live* · *is due to arrive* · *we'll still be testing* · *is on the verge of signing* · *will you be joining* · *is to attend* · *is bound to have* · *If we're to get*. **A plan that didn't happen:** "We were to have launched it in May." **Tactful question:** "Will you be joining the meeting?" It asks about Daniel's plans without asking him to decide on the spot or implying he must come.

◆ PROJECT BRIEFING – MODEL (PROJECT 2, NORTHGATE HEALTH CLINIC)

Thanks for your time. At the steering meeting on June 30, the movers will be transferring the last of the equipment to the new building. By then, we'll have moved all the patient records and trained every receptionist on the new check-in screens, and the IT team will have been testing the phone system for six weeks. We were going to open on June 2, but the elevator inspection was postponed. The inspection is due to take place on July 3, and we're on the verge of signing the parking agreement with the city. The mayor is to open the building on July 15. If we are to keep that date, we'll need two extra IT staff in the first week.

Stakeholder questions (model): *Will you be needing volunteers on moving day?* · *Will patients still be using the old entrance in July?* · *Will the pharmacy be opening at the same time?*

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"By the time you arrive, we ___ for hours." Which form best expresses duration up to that future point?

A) will be waiting

B) have been waiting

C) will have been waiting

Why: the future perfect continuous measures an ongoing activity up to a future point (*by the time you arrive*). A shows only that we'll be waiting at that moment, not the duration; B is present perfect, anchored to now.

Q2

"We ___ take the earlier train, but it was fully booked." Choose the natural "future in the past" form.

A) will

B) were going to

C) would have taken

Why: *was / were going to* reports an earlier plan that wasn't carried out. A is present-future; C is a third-conditional result and would need a condition (*would have taken it if...*).

Q3 · new

"According to the press release, the director ___ visit the site on Friday."

A) is to

B) is about to

C) would

Why: *be to* reports an official arrangement, the language of press releases and announcements. B means "any moment now" and can't take a future time phrase like "on Friday"; C is a future seen from the past and doesn't fit a present report.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (1.1)

"By the time we will finish..." · "When the client will arrive, ..." · "By June I will work here for ten years." (present or simple future for a duration) · "...since ten years" · "will have been knowing / owning" · "We're about to sign next week." · "we will finished" / "I will been working" (dropped auxiliary) · "You are to report" read as a suggestion. **Appropriacy:** future perfects in casual chat ("I'll have been eating by then, lol") and blunt "Will you use...?" to a senior colleague. For range, praise *was to have + pp*, *If we are to...*, and a well-placed *on the verge of*.

1.2 · ADVANCED MODALITY — SPECULATION & NUANCE (C2)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE TUESDAY SLUMP (SCRIPT 1.2-A)

1	can't be	R ruled out
2	might be	P possible
3	can't possibly have started	R ruled out
4	may well have switched	L quite likely
5	would always order	H past habit
6	must be	C near-certain
7	are bound to be	C near-certain (a prediction)
8	might as well try	D a decision

Extra modals in the script to notice: *she won't be the reason* (deduction), *It should bring some people in* (expectation), *It could conceivably work* (a slim chance). Follow-up: "Is *may well have switched* a guess or a fact?" (A well-founded guess: the evidence is circumstantial.)

◆ EXERCISE 2 – RANK BY CERTAINTY

a. Least → most certain that it will rain: **c, b, d, a** (c rules it out · b bare possibility · d quite likely · a near-certain deduction).

b. Weakest → strongest claim: **g, e, i, h, f**, where "weakest" means the lowest position on the dial. g = ruled out (*can't possibly have*) · e = a slim chance (*could conceivably*) · i = possible (*might*) · h = quite likely (*may well have*) · f = near-certain prediction (*is bound to*).

Accept **e** and **i** in either order if the learner explains the difference well: *could conceivably* stresses "only just possible," bare *might* is neutral. Some learners argue that **g** is the "strongest" claim (it is very certain, but of a negative). Agree, and point out that the question is about the dial position.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CHOOSE THE NUANCE

- 1 may as well (no reason not to; the best option left)
- 2 must (near-certain deduction)
- 3 may well (quite likely)
- 4 can't (ruled out on the evidence)
- 5 may as well (nothing stops us; a decision)
- 6 may well (a strong but hedged prediction)

Accept *might as well* in 1 and 5 and *could well / might well* in 3 and 6 if learners change the word. **Wrong:** 1 "may well" (turns a decision into a probability) · 6 "may as well drop" (means "they might as well drop": nonsense here).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE JOB OF WILL / WOULD

- 1 habitual past (a repeated routine)
- 2 criticism / characteristic behavior ("that's so typical of him")
- 3 politeness: softened advice (also a conditional frame, "if I were you": accept either with a reason)
- 4 past refusal (an object's persistent failure)
- 5 narrative future in the past
- 6 present deduction (a confident guess about now)
- 7 refusal now / persistent failure
- 8 typical behavior (what she habitually does; her nature)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – NOW OR PAST?

- 1 He **must have been joking**.
- 2 They **can't have known** about the changes. (also: *can't possibly have known · couldn't have known*)
- 3 She **might be waiting** outside (right now). (also: *may / could be waiting*)
- 4 They **should have arrived** by now. (also: *ought to have arrived*)
- 5 The email **may well have gone** to spam. (also: *might / could well have gone*)
- 6 She **must have been working** all night.

Wrong: 1 "must be joking" (present) · 2 "mustn't have known" (L1 transfer; the negative of deduction is *can't have*) · 4 "should arrive by now" · 6 "must have worked all night" (acceptable, but loses the ongoing activity) · any "must have went / gone to spam" confusion: "must have **gone**."

◆ DIALOGUE – THE DARK OFFICE

must have left (near-certain, past) · *may well have* (quite likely, ellipsis of "left") · *might just be* (a slim chance, now) · *won't answer* (typical behavior / refusal) · *might as well email (a decision)* · *should reply* (expectation) · *would be very her* (characteristic behavior) · *It would, wouldn't it* (characteristic, echoed) · *could have been planning* (possible, past ongoing).

◆ THE EVIDENCE LADDER – CASE SOLUTIONS (READ ALOUD AT THE REVEAL)

Case 1 • The Vanishing Deliveries	The tenant on the 4th floor changed its company name in February (Brightline Design → Kestrel Studio), but the lobby directory and the couriers' address database still show the old name. Couriers who can't match the name leave packages at the 2nd-floor reception, where they sit until someone recognizes them. Red herrings: the new mail-room temp (started <i>after</i> the problem began) and the broken elevator (fixed in a day). Model verdict: <i>It can't possibly have been the temp; the problem started two weeks before she arrived. The name change must have confused the couriers, and packages are bound to keep going astray until the directory is updated. I'd suggest we update the directory and email every supplier this week.</i>
Case 2 • The 3 a.m. Alert	The new cloud backup (set up in October to run every Thursday at 3 a.m.) clashes with the automatic software update that the old IT contractor scheduled for the same night. Both jobs use the server at full capacity. Red herrings: the cleaning crew (they have no passwords and the server room is locked) and the vending-machine Wi-Fi. Model verdict: <i>The cleaners can't possibly have caused it. The backup and the update may well be running at the same time; the timing points to that. It's bound to happen again next Thursday unless one of them is moved. We might as well move the backup to Sunday.</i>
Case 3 • The Empty Training Room	Several causes together, which is the point: the course was advertised only online (the website and social media), the few printed flyers showed the wrong day (Tuesday instead of Thursday), and the sign-up form required an online account, which many of the people who asked for the course don't have. The date also falls in a school-holiday week. Model verdict: <i>No single cause explains it. The wrong day on the flyer must have cost us some people, and the online-only form may well have put off many more. The holiday week could conceivably be a factor too. I'd suggest paper sign-up sheets at the front desk and a new date.</i>
Case 4 • The Missing Saturday Volunteers	In March the city changed the Saturday bus schedule: the first Route 12 bus now arrives at 9:40, but the garden's volunteer shift still starts at 9:00. Most regular volunteers don't drive. Red herrings: the new coordinator (volunteers like her; weekday numbers are up) and the move to a group-chat app (Saturday messages are read). Model verdict: <i>It can't be the new coordinator; weekday numbers have gone up since she started. The bus change must be the main reason: the first bus doesn't arrive until 9:40. People are bound to keep missing the start. We might as well move the shift to 10:00.</i>

Groups rarely match the solution exactly. Mark the **reasoning**: did each hypothesis sit on the right rung for the evidence? Did it move when the evidence changed? Did the group avoid blaming a person without evidence? A group that keeps a hypothesis at *could conceivably* and says why has done excellent C1 work, even if it's not the answer.

Q1

"The stores are closed, so we ___ order in." Which fits, meaning there's no better option?

A) may as well

B) may well

C) can't

Why: *may / might as well* = there's no better option, a decision with a shrug. B is about probability ("we'll quite likely order in"), which doesn't fit "so"; C contradicts the logic.

Q2

In "Every winter we'd skate on the frozen pond," what job is *would* doing?

A) Conditional (result of a condition)

B) Habitual past (a repeated routine)

C) Politeness / softening

Why: an established past setting ("every winter") with no condition, and a repeated action: habitual *would*, like *used to* for actions.

Q3 · new

"The lights are on and her car's in the driveway. She ___ gone away for the weekend."

A) can't possibly have

B) may well have

C) must have

Why: the evidence (lights on, car still there) rules the idea out, so the speaker needs the bottom of the dial, in the past: *can't (possibly) have + pp*. B and C point the wrong way on the evidence.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (1.2)

"It may as well rain" (meaning likely) · "He must have went / must of gone" · "He mustn't have known" (for impossibility) · "He must be lying yesterday" · "When I was a child I'd have a bike" (habitual *would* with a state) · "He should be at home: the lights are on" (where *must* is meant) · "It is bound to rain yesterday." · stacked hedges ("it may possibly perhaps be..."). **Appropriacy:** over-certainty about people ("It's definitely the temp's fault") and the criticism *would* ("You would say that") used to a manager. For range, praise *could conceivably*, *may well have*, *is bound to* and a well-timed "That'll be...".

1.3 · THE SUBJUNCTIVE & UNREAL USES (C3)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE COMMITTEE'S RECOMMENDATIONS (SCRIPT 1.3-A)

1	be updated	5	were
2	attend	6	were
3	not be asked	7	took
4	have		

Items 1–4 are mandative (base form: passive, active, negative passive, *have not has*). Items 5–6 are unreal *were*. Item 7: *it's high time* + past simple. Learners often hear "attends" or "has": replay the line and ask "Is it a fact or a recommendation?"

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THE MANDATIVE SUBJUNCTIVE

- 1 be extended
- 2 be
- 3 not answer
- 4 be retained
- 5 have
- 6 submit
- 7 be reviewed · not be required

Also correct: *should* + base in every item (*should be extended*, *should not answer*). **Wrong:** 1 "is extended / extends" · 3 "doesn't answer / not to answer / didn't answer" · 5 "has" · 6 "submits" · 7 "is reviewed," "are not required," "don't be required."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – REGISTER AND MEANING

- 1 should apply

- 2 be waived
- 3 should arrive
- 4 not sign
- 5 **works** (*suggest* = show: a fact, indicative)
- 6 **be tested** (*suggest* = propose: subjunctive; also *should be tested*)
- 7 **had sent** (*insist* = assert a fact; backshifted; also *sent*)
- 8 **send** (*insist* = demand; also *should send*)

Items 1–4: both versions are correct; the subjunctive is more formal and the standard American choice, *should* the characteristically British one. Item 5 "work" (subjunctive) is the classic over-correction: praise the awareness, then show the lookalike.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – UNREAL USES

- 1 is (real: the speaker thinks it genuinely might snow)
- 2 owned (unreal: he doesn't own it)
- 3 were (unreal *were*: we aren't old friends; accept *was* in informal use)
- 4 knows (real: treated as plausibly true)
- 5 updated (*it's high time* + past simple; also *should update*, less emphatic)
- 6 Were (inversion: only *were*)
- 7 rejected / were to reject (also *was to reject* informally)
- 8 didn't forward (*would rather* + past for another person's action)

Wrong: 2 "owns" (treats it as possibly true) · 5 "update / will update" · 6 "Was" · 8 "don't forward / not forward / wouldn't forward."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – EDIT THE MEMO

- 1 We recommend that each manager **send** the report by Friday.
- 2 It is vital that the kitchen **not be left** dirty overnight.
- 3 They demanded that he **apologize** in writing. (also: *They demanded an apology in writing.*)
- 4 **Were** I in charge, I would change the schedule. (also: *If I were / was in charge, ...*)
- 5 We ask that visitors **not park** in the loading area.
- 6 He acts as if he **owned** the place. (he doesn't: unreal)

- 7 The grammar is right but the register is wrong: a mandative subjunctive in a friendly text sounds absurdly official (or deliberately comic). → *Don't forget the snacks on Saturday!* / *Can you bring snacks on Saturday?*

◆ DIALOGUE – PREPARING THE RECOMMENDATION

Mandative subjunctives (3): *(I recommend) that every meeting have · that Wednesdays be kept · that managers not invite*. **Other unreal forms (4):** *It's high time we did · Were we to do nothing · Suppose the directors refused · I'd rather you did*. **As if:** *as if it were the end of the world*. **Fixed phrases (2):** *Be that as it may · If need be*. Note the second conditional in "we'd lose" and "we'd pilot" as results of the unreal forms.

◆ POLICY MEMO – MODEL (BRIEF 1, MEETING OVERLOAD · POSITION A)

To: Senior Leadership Team · **From:** Operations Working Group · **Date:** March 14 · **Re:** Reducing meeting time

Background. *Our staff survey shows that employees spend an average of 14 hours a week in meetings, and many report attending meetings as though attendance itself were the goal.* **Recommendations.** *1. We recommend that every meeting have a written agenda circulated 24 hours in advance. 2. It is essential that Wednesdays be kept free of internal meetings, on a trial basis for one quarter. 3. Our proposal is that managers not invite more than six people unless a decision requires it.* **Rationale.** *Were we to recover even a quarter of this time, each employee would gain three and a half hours a week for focused work.* **Next steps.** *It is high time we measured the cost of meetings. If need be, the working group will pilot these changes in the Logistics department first.* (132 words)

Check: three trigger types (verb, adjective, noun) ✓ · negative ✓ · passive ✓ · unreal form ✓ · *as though* ✓ · formal, consistent tone ✓.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"The regulations require that each application ____ signed by a supervisor."

A) be

B) is

C) has to be

Why: *require that* is a mandative trigger: the base form (here a passive, *be signed*) for every person. B is the informal indicative, heard but not appropriate in regulations; C repeats the obligation already in *require*.

Q2

"He strode past us without a word, as if he ____ us at all." The speaker means he did recognize them but pretended not to.

A) doesn't know

B) wouldn't have known

C) didn't know

Why: the comparison is contrary to fact (he did know them), so *as if* takes a past form. A is present and treats it as possibly true; B is a conditional perfect that doesn't fit an unreal comparison.

Q3 · new

"For security reasons, we ask that staff ____ their passwords with anyone."

A) not share

B) don't share

C) not to share

Why: the negative mandative subjunctive is *not* + base form, with no *do* and no *to*. B is the indicative (informal, and odd after *ask that*); C mixes in the infinitive of "ask staff not to share."

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (1.3)

"We recommend that he goes" · "that she doesn't attend" · "that he to leave" · "I want that you come" (*want* is not a trigger) · "It is possible that he be late" (overextension from a Romance L1) · "Was I in charge..." · "It's time that we go" · "as if he owns the place" (for unreal) · "The data suggests that the system be working" (lookalike over-correction). **Appropriacy:** subjunctives and fossil phrases in casual messages ("Suffice it to say the pizza was good"), and *like* for *as if* in a formal memo ("It feels like we are ignoring the problem"). For range, praise *Were we to...*, a well-placed passive subjunctive, and *Be that as it may* used once, not three times.

Module 2 — Conditionals, Inversion & Emphasis: Answers

Answers to every Module 2 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the reasoning, acceptable alternatives, model versions of the open tasks (a case-study analysis, a rewritten speech, an edited article, a spoken correction) and the errors you are most likely to hear.

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C4-C6

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **accuracy, range and appropriacy**. A sentence is right when the structure is correct (the time logic of each conditional clause, auxiliary + subject after a fronted trigger, *be* agreeing with the focus in a cleft) **and** the choice suits the meaning and the occasion. An inversion in a text message, or three clefts in a row, can be grammatical and still be marked down for appropriacy: say so, and say why. Be generous with genuine options: *was / were* after *if I / she* (prefer *were* in formal writing), *that / who / zero* in clefts, *provided / providing (that)*, *so long as / as long as*, *must / should* after *On no account*. American English is the model; accept British spellings and forms (*realise, apologise, cancelled, got for gotten*). When a learner produces a correct alternative to the target, accept it and nudge: "Correct. Now try it with *but for*."

2.1 • MIXED CONDITIONALS & ALTERNATIVES TO "IF" (C4)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – "THE HINGE" PODCAST (SCRIPT 2.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
had accepted · would be	weren't · would have taken	But for	provided that	in case	were to	Unless

Accept *'d be* in 1, *wasn't* in 2 (but point out that the script uses *weren't*), *providing (that)* in 4. The hinge factor: Brightwell **turned down the Swift Deliveries contract** in 2022, largely because of the founder's cautious character; that caution later helped it survive the battery shortage. Items 1 and 2 are the two directions of mixed conditional: ask "When is the condition? When is the result?" for each.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – DIAGNOSE THE TIME

- 1 hadn't signed · wouldn't be paying (also *wouldn't pay*) · **P→Pr**
- 2 were (also *was*) · wouldn't have resigned · **Pr→P** (a permanent trait explains a past action)
- 3 had tested · would still trust · **P→Pr**
- 4 spoke · would have gone · **Pr→P**

5 had listened · might be · $P \rightarrow Pr$

6 weren't (also *wasn't*) · would never have offered · $Pr \rightarrow P$

Wrong: 1 "wouldn't have paid ... now" (habitual symmetry) · 2 "hadn't been ... wouldn't have resigned" is a correct *third* conditional but loses the "he is impatient by nature" meaning; accept it grammatically, then ask "Is he still impatient?" · 3 "would have still trusted us today" · 4 "If I had spoken" (third conditional: possible only if the learner means a one-off past failure to speak it, not a general inability) · 5 "might have been in profit by now" (acceptable only as speculation about the past; *by now* signals the present).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE EXACT ALTERNATIVE

1 on condition that (a formal, explicit stipulation from a bank)

2 in case (a precaution, taken now)

3 Supposing

4 Even if (the result holds regardless)

5 provided that **or** as long as

6 unless (= except if)

7 otherwise

8 as long as **or** provided that (whichever was not used in 5)

5 and 8 are interchangeable; *provided that* sounds slightly more transactional, *as long as* slightly more conversational. In 1, *provided that* is also grammatical, but *on condition that* is the most formal fit for a bank's stipulation. **Wrong:** 2 "if sales drop" (then the money would be set aside only after the drop, which misses the precaution) · 6 "if the tests reveal" reverses the meaning.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ISOLATE THE DECISIVE FACTOR

1 But for the engineers' quick action, the data would have been lost. / If it hadn't been for the engineers' quick action, ...

2 If it weren't for the noise from the street, the office would be perfect. / But for the noise from the street, ...

3 If it hadn't been for a single investor (who believed in us), we would never have launched. / But for one investor's faith in us, ...

4 If it weren't for our volunteers, the festival would stop. / But for our volunteers, ...

5 But for a chance meeting at a trade fair, the partnership would never have happened. / If it hadn't been for a chance meeting...

Present reality (2, 4) → *if it weren't for*; past reality (1, 3, 5) → *if it hadn't been for*; *but for* works for both. Accept *Were it not for* / *Had it not been for* (previewed; taught in 2.2). **Wrong:** "But for the engineers acted quickly" (a clause after *but*

for) · "If it wasn't for... would have been lost" (time mismatch in 1) · "If it hadn't been for the noise, the office would be perfect" in 2 (the noise is still there).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – RIGHT OR WRONG?

- 1 ✗ ...I **would be** an analyst now. (past condition → present result)
- 2 ✗ I'd be amazed **if she didn't get** the promotion. (*unless* can't express an unreal negative emotion; test: "except if" doesn't fit)
- 3 ✓ (a genuine precaution)
- 4 ✗ If the price **fell** (or **were to fall**), we would buy more stock. (no *would* in the if-clause)
- 5 ✗ But for **your help**, I would have missed the deadline. (*but for* + noun)
- 6 ✗ Call me **if** you need anything, and I'll come straight over. (the call depends on the need: a condition, not a precaution)
- 7 ✓ (tentative *should*, inverted; a preview of 2.2)

◆ DIALOGUE – TWO CO-FOUNDERS LOOK BACK, AND AHEAD

Mixed conditionals: "If we hadn't opened five cafés in one year, we'd still have money in the bank" (P→Pr) · "if we weren't such an impatient pair, we'd never have gotten the first one off the ground" (Pr→P). **But for:** "but for Maria's weekend markets, Elm Street would have closed last spring." **Alternatives:** provided that · supposing · as long as · in case · even if · unless · on condition that (+ tentative *if the board should ask*). **The precaution:** "we hold three months' rent in reserve *in case* a renewal falls through."

◆ SPEAKING – THE CASE STUDY PANEL (MODEL ANALYSIS, CASE 1: HARBOR FRESH)

"Harbor Fresh's turning point came in 2022, when it decided not to build its own warehouse. **If it had built that warehouse, it would be the market leader today:** GreenCart made exactly that investment and now holds that position. Why did Harbor Fresh hesitate? **If its CEO weren't so wary of debt, he would have borrowed the \$400,000 without a second thought.** When its only wholesaler went bankrupt in 2023, the shelves were empty for three weeks, and **but for the Riverside Farmers' Co-op, which supplied it free for two weeks, the company would have closed.** Our recommendation is to accept the co-op's partnership offer, **provided that** the minimum order is reviewed every six months, and to keep a second wholesaler on standby **in case** the harvest fails. **Even if** costs rise slightly, the security is worth it. **Should** a competitor try to buy the co-op, Harbor Fresh would need the right to match the offer. And **if the market were to** recover strongly next year, a small warehouse of its own would finally make sense." (Tick: P→Pr, Pr→P, *but for*, *even if* + *provided that* + *in case*, *should*, *were to*.)

Accept any analysis that is faithful to the case facts and meets the checklist. Mark down for appropriacy if *but for* is used with a clause, or if *in case* is used for a condition ("we'll buy a warehouse in case the market recovers").

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"If I ___ that email yesterday, I wouldn't be in this mess now." Which completes this mixed conditional?

A) didn't send

B) wouldn't have sent

C) hadn't sent

Why: the condition is an unreal *past* action (yesterday), so it needs the past perfect; the result is present (*now*). A is a second-conditional form (present unreal); B is a result form, never used in the if-clause.

Q2

"I'll take my charger ___ the battery dies on the train." Which best fits a precaution taken in advance?

A) if

B) in case

C) unless

Why: *in case* = I take it now because the battery might die later. With *if*, you would only take the charger at the moment the battery died. *Unless* reverses the sense.

Q3 · new

"We'll sign the contract ___ the delivery date stays in March. That's our only condition."

A) provided that

B) in case

C) even if

Why: "our only condition" signals a strict, negotiated condition: *provided that* (or *as long as* / *on condition that*). *In case* is a precaution; *even if* means the signing happens regardless.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (2.1)

"If I had studied medicine, I would have been a doctor now." · "If it would rain, we'd cancel." · "I'll bring a jacket if it gets cold" when a precaution is meant, and the reverse, "Call me in case you need help" for a condition · "Unless she came, I'd be surprised." · "But for you helped me..." · "If it wasn't for the grant, we would have closed" (time mismatch: needed *hadn't been*) · "provide that" / "provided if" · "in the case that" for *in case*.
Praise range: *were to, should, but for, even if, on condition that*, and modal variety in the result clause (*might have caught, could be*).

2.2 · INVERSION FOR EMPHASIS & STYLE (C5)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE ACCEPTANCE SPEECH (SCRIPT 2.2-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
have I been	did I imagine	did you keep	was the response (from our neighbors)	Had it not been	will we be

Triggers: 1 *Never* · 2 *Little* · 3 *Not only* · 4 *So + adjective* · 5 conditional inversion · 6 *Only by*. The speech has six inversions in about 180 words: a good discussion point for the follow-up question. Most learners cut 2 or 6; any cut with a reason is acceptable.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FRONT AND INVERT

- 1 Seldom have I read such a persuasive report.
- 2 At no time was the public in danger.
- 3 Only when the audit was complete did we understand the scale of the problem.
- 4 Not only did she meet the deadline, but she (also) came in under budget.
- 5 Hardly had the meeting begun when the power went out.
- 6 Under no circumstances should you leave the lab unlocked.
- 7 Not until the following morning did the truth emerge.

In 3, the inversion happens in the **main** clause, not after *when*: "Only when the audit was complete **did we** understand." **Wrong**: "Only when was the audit complete..." · 4 "Not only she met" / "Not only did she met" · 5 "Hardly the meeting had begun" · 7 "Not until the following morning the truth emerged."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DROP "IF"

- 1 Had we known about the delay, we would have rebooked.
- 2 Should you require further information, please contact our office.
- 3 Were the factory to close, the town would lose its largest employer.

- 4 Had it not been for the volunteers, the event would have been canceled.
- 5 Were I in your position, I would accept the offer.
- 6 Should you not receive a confirmation within 48 hours, please call us.

6 needs *should* because the original is a real (first-conditional) possibility; the inverted form adds politeness. **Wrong:**
 4 "Hadn't it been for" (a question form) · 6 "Shouldn't you receive" · "Did we know about the delay" (only *had*, *were*, *should* invert) · 3 "Would the factory close".

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FAULTY OR FINE?

- 1 Never **have** I seen such a turnout.
- 2 Rarely does the director **admit** a mistake. (tense lives on *does* only)
- 3 **Had we not** left early, we would have missed the train.
- 4 ✓ Correct: *Only Sarah* is the subject, not a fronted adverbial.
- 5 Not until the end of the meeting **did she mention** the budget.
- 6 Look, here **it comes!** (no place inversion with a pronoun)
- 7 So impressive **were the results** that the board approved the plan.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WEIGHT OR POMP?

- 1 ✗ (unless the learner means it as a joke, which is a legitimate use; accept with that explanation) → "I've never eaten such an enormous burrito!"
- 2 ✓ A tribute is exactly the occasion for weight.
- 3 ✓ Safety notices use emphatic prohibition; this is standard.
- 4 ✗ Too formal for a quick lunch email (*shall* adds to the stiffness) → "If you'd like to join us for lunch, we'll be at the café at noon."
- 5 ✓ Reviews reward emphatic openings.
- 6 ✗ Four inversions crowd four sentences: they stop emphasizing and start sounding pompous. → e.g. "Never have we grown so fast. We hired more people than ever, and both profits and morale rose. Now we can see the results."

◆ DIALOGUE – THE SPEECHWRITER'S EDIT

"**Never have** I worked with anyone quite like Grace" (*Never*) · "**Only when** the water went down **did we** realize..." (*Only when*) · "**So calm was she** that nobody panicked" (*So* + adjective): the writer advised against it because it would be the third inversion in a row, and density turns weight into pomp · "**Should you** ever need a book found..." (conditional inversion, warm and slightly playful in a closing line).

◆ SPEAKING – THE SPEECHWRITER (MODEL, BRIEF 1: TRIBUTE TO WALTER CHEN)

"For twenty-eight years, Walter Chen has kept Riverside High running. **Never have I met** anyone who knows a building so well. During the blizzard of 2011 he fixed the boiler, and told no one. **Only when** the heating bills arrived **did we** find out. **So modest was he** that most students never learned his name, though every one of them knew his whistle. **Had it not been for** Walter, this school would have closed more times than I can count. He never missed a graduation, and he never once complained. **Should you** ever need a door fixed, please don't call Walter: he's retired. Please raise your glasses: to Walter."

Five inversions, four different types, and the plain sentences between them ("He never missed a graduation...") are deliberate. A sixth ("Not until he took a vacation did we understand how much he did") is exactly what the editor should cut. Models for Briefs 2–4 are printed at the foot of each brief card (classroom materials, set D). When marking, check the tick-boxes, then judge: did every inversion earn its place?

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which is the correct inversion of "She rarely admits a mistake"?

A) Rarely does she admit a mistake.

B) Rarely she admits a mistake.

C) Rarely does she admits a mistake.

Why: no auxiliary in the original, so borrow *does*, and the main verb goes bare. B has no inversion; C marks the tense twice.

Q2

Which correctly rewrites "If I had known, I would have called" with conditional inversion?

A) Had I known, I would have called.

B) Would I have known, I would have called.

C) Did I know, I would have called.

Why: drop *if* and front the auxiliary *had*. Only *had*, *were* and *should* can invert in a conditional.

Q3 · new

Which sentence is correct?

A) Not only she apologized, but also she offered a refund.

B) Not only did she apologize, but she also offered a refund.

C) Not only did she apologized, but she also offered a refund.

Why: fronted *Not only* needs *did* + subject + bare verb; the second clause keeps normal word order (*but she also offered*). A has no inversion; C double-marks the past.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (2.2)

"Never I have seen..." · "Never saw I..." (verb-second transfer) · "Rarely does she admits..." · "Little did I knew..." · "Hadn't I known..." · "Only when did the audit finish..." (inverting the wrong clause) · "Not only did he lie, but also did he..." (inverting both clauses) · "Here comes it." · "That book have I never read." (inverting after an ordinary topic) · **Density:** four inversions in a 100-word paragraph. Praise judgment as much as form: a learner who explains why they *didn't* invert a line has understood the lesson.

2.3 · CLEFT SENTENCES & FRONTING FOR COHESION (C6)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE RADIO INTERVIEW (SCRIPT 2.3-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
wasn't · that	What we noticed	wasn't until	All we	was that	we didn't lose

Accept *which* in 1 (informal). The misconception: that Nadia banned laptops because she dislikes them. What actually happened: lunch customers were leaving because laptop users filled the tables at midday, so she asked for a two-hour pause, and the morning regulars stayed. Item 6 is fronting, not a cleft: ask learners to spot the difference.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – REWRITE FOR FOCUS

- 1 It was the new manager who (that) changed the schedule.
- 2 It was the weather, not the budget, that made us cancel the event. / It was because of the weather, not the budget, that we canceled the event.
- 3 What I need is more time.
- 4 What happened was (that) the server (simply) overheated.
- 5 All I want is a straight answer.
- 6 The reason (why) I'm calling is that the invoice is wrong.

7 It wasn't until Monday that we noticed the error.

Wrong: 1 "It was the new manager which changed" · 3 "What I need it is more time" · 6 "The reason I'm calling is because..." (accept in speech, correct in writing) · 7 "It wasn't until Monday when we noticed" (common; prefer *that*) · "It was on Monday that we only noticed" (keeps *only* and the cleft).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FRONT THE LINKING ELEMENT

1 The second (one), it accepted immediately. / The second it accepted immediately.

2 The first one, we will never use again.

3 Even more serious is the cost of further delay. (fronted comparative; *be* inverts)

4 Of the three, training was the most popular request.

Only 3 inverts, because *Even more serious* is a fronted complement of *be*. **Wrong:** "The first one we will never use it again" (resumptive pronoun) · "The second one did it accept" (inversion without a trigger).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MOVE THE WEIGHT TO THE END

1 It surprised nobody that the project was late.

2 It is (It's) still unclear whether the client will renew.

3 It is impossible to finish the whole report by Friday.

4 It is no surprise that she was offered the job.

Wrong: "Is still unclear whether..." (missing dummy *it*) · "It surprised nobody the project was late" (acceptable in speech; keep *that* in writing).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WHICH CONTINUATION FLOWS BETTER?

1 (a) · 2 (b) · 3 (b) · 4 (a)

1: a corrective it-cleft affirms the real cause and denies the assumed one in one move; (b) is clumsy. 2: *the first* is given (one of the two options), so fronting it links back and leaves the new verdict for the end; (a) front-loads a heavy clause. 3: end-weight: the heavy *that*-clause belongs at the end. 4: *staff* and *money* are given; *time* is the new, contrasting point, so the what-cleft saves it for the end; (b) is possible but clumsy, and "have not got" is British and informal.

◆ DIALOGUE – SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT

It-clefts: "it wasn't the money that closed it" (corrective) · "It was space" (a shortened cleft: *It was space [that closed it]*) · "It was in March that we first consulted members." **What / all:** "What the figures show is a return rate of ninety-six percent" · "All we're doing is moving them." **Reason frame:** "The reason it felt sudden is that the notice went up late."

Fronting: "That part, I fully accept." The corrective cleft is the first one: it denies the money explanation and puts space in its place.

◆ SPEAKING – THE EDITING DESK (MODEL, ARTICLE A)

"Tallis Print Works, a small printing company in Riverside with 40 employees, moved to a four-day week last year. Many people expected productivity to fall. **What actually happened was that** it rose by eight percent. **It wasn't the shorter week on its own that** caused the rise, though; **it was** better scheduling. Every job is now planned on Monday morning. **Even more surprising is** the fall in sick days, which nobody predicted. The change was a risk, says the owner, Ruth Tallis, but it is one she is glad she took."

Two clefts, one fronted comparative, a passive that keeps "every job" (given) up front, and plain order everywhere else. Models for Articles B and C:

B (Eastgate nap pods): "Eastgate Distribution Center, a warehouse near the airport that runs around the clock, installed two nap pods for night-shift workers last year. Some managers laughed at the idea, but the results were no joke: accidents on the night shift fell by a third. It wasn't the pods alone that made the difference. What also mattered was a new rule, a twenty-minute break after every four hours, and it was the workers, not management, who suggested it. Other warehouses are now asking Eastgate for advice. As for the pods, they are staying."

C (Greenway garden): "The vegetable garden at Greenway Middle School was a parent's idea, and nobody expected much from it. What happened surprised everyone: attendance improved on Fridays, when the garden club meets. The garden has become a classroom, too; every week the science teacher's students measure how their plants have grown. The vegetables they grow, the cafeteria now serves, and students are eating more salad than ever. Summer is harder. It is neighborhood volunteers who water the garden while the school is closed."

Accept any version that keeps every fact, moves given information forward and new information to the end, and uses no more than three clefts. Mark down a version that clefts *given* information ("It was the company that moved to a four-day week").

◆ SPEAKING – SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT (MODEL CORRECTIONS, CARDS 1-6)

- 1 "Actually, it wasn't theft that closed the tool library; it was space. What the figures show is a return rate of 96 percent, and the service reopens at the community center in June."
- 2 "It isn't technology that Nadia objects to. What she needed was lunch seating. All she did was ask for a two-hour pause at midday."
- 3 "It wasn't a lack of riders that stopped the Number 9. Around 1,200 people use it every week. The reason it's paused is that the road works forced a merger with the Number 4 until September."
- 4 "The pool isn't closing because it's unsafe. What's happening is a six-week closure for a new heating system, and when it reopens, the hours will actually be longer."
- 5 "No data was lost. It was a power failure at the data center, not a hack, that caused the outage, and it was the backup system that protected every account."
- 6 "Pay hasn't changed at all. What has changed is the length of the day: nine hours instead of eight, over four days. And productivity is up eight percent."

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Rewrite "I admire her honesty most of all" as a cleft that delivers the focus at the end. Which is the natural what-cleft?

A) It is her honesty that I admire most of all.

B) What I admire most of all is her honesty.

C) Her honesty, I admire most of all.

Why: the what-cleft withholds the focus and delivers it last. A is an it-cleft (focus up front); C is fronting, not a cleft.

Q2

Context: "We reviewed three designs." Which continuation best respects cohesion and end-weight?

A) That we rejected the last one outright is what happened.

B) We rejected the last one outright.

C) The last, we rejected outright.

Why: *the last* is given (one of the three just mentioned), so fronting it links straight back, and the new verdict (*rejected outright*) lands at the end. B is grammatical and acceptable, but the link to the three designs is weaker; A is top-heavy.

Q3 • new

Which is the best version for a formal report?

A) The reason sales fell is because the store moved.

B) The reason sales fell is that the store moved.

C) The reason sales fell, it is that the store moved.

Why: *the reason* already means "the cause," so formal writing uses *is that*. A is common in speech but redundant; C adds a resumptive *it*.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (2.3)

"What surprised us is the silence" (frozen *is* for a past event) · "What I need are more time" / "What we need is some answers" (agreement: accept *is* with plural focus in speech) · "It was her who..." (accept; formal *It was she who* is C2 and rare) · "The reason is because..." · "Is important that..." / "Is a pity that..." (missing *it*) · "That book, I have read it" (resumptive pronoun) · "That book have I never read" (inversion without a trigger) · clefting given information · **cleft overload**: "It was... What... The reason..." in three consecutive sentences.

◆ GAME – THE EMPHASIS TRACK (ANSWER CARD)

Model answers for the board squares are printed on the answer card in the classroom materials (set F), so groups can check themselves. Accept any correct alternative; the referee has the final word, and the teacher settles disputes.

Module 3 — Cohesion, Register & Style: Answers

Answers to every Module 3 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the two-register rewrite, the repaired reports, the difficult conversations), and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **accuracy, range and appropriacy**. Most items in this module are rewrites with many good answers, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) keeps the original meaning and every fact, (2) is grammatically accurate (the real noun, the right preposition after it, *so / not*, the anchor word in ellipsis), and (3) fits the reader and the room: nominal and impersonal for a report, plain and direct for a notice, softened but clear for a difficult conversation. When a learner's version is correct but differs from the target structure, accept it and point to the target: "Good. Can you also do it with a light verb?" American English is the model; accept British spellings (*nominalisation, behaviour, analyse, favour*). Contractions are fine in speech and in the plain-English notices, not in the formal summaries.

3.1 • NOMINALIZATION & ACADEMIC STYLE (C7)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE UPDATE AND THE SUMMARY (SCRIPT 3.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
introduction	assessment	increase	failure	reduction	approval	implementation

Spoken verb → noun: *brought in* → introduction · *looked at how they did* → assessment · *went up* → increase · *failed* → failure · *dropped* → reduction · *said yes* → approval · *roll out* → implementation. Accept *evaluation* for 2 and *rise* for 3 if the learner hears them that way; they fit. Spelling errors to expect: *assesment, implemantation, faillure*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — FORM THE NOUN

- 1 development
- 2 awareness
- 3 arrival
- 4 ability
- 5 failure

- 6 analysis
- 7 strength
- 8 (an) increase (zero-derivation)
- 9 belief
- 10 refusal
- 11 complexity
- 12 dependence (also *dependency*)
- 13 choice
- 14 growth

Stress: 4 *Able* → *aBility* (moves) · 8 *to inCREASE* → *an INcrease* (moves) · 11 *comPLEX* / *COMplex* → *comPLEXity* (the stress lands just before *-ity*). **Wrong:** "the arrivement," "ableness," "the failment," "analyst" (a person), "strongness," "the choosing," "believe" as a noun.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – LIGHT VERBS AND PREPOSITIONS

- 1 carried out / conducted · **into** (also *of* with *conducted*)
- 2 reached / made / came to
- 3 poses · **to**
- 4 had · **on**
- 5 places / placed / puts · **on**
- 6 provided / offered / given · **for**
- 7 **in**
- 8 draw / reach

Wrong: "made an investigation," "did a decision," "has an impact in," "an increase of demand," "an explanation of the delay" (possible, but *for* is the natural choice after *provide an explanation*). *take a decision* is British; accept it.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FROM VERBAL TO ACADEMIC (MODELS; WORDING MAY VARY)

- 1 An investigation was carried out into the failure of the system. / The causes of the system failure were investigated.
- 2 The company's rapid expansion led to a reduction in its unit costs.
- 3 No explanation was provided for the difference in the results.

- 4 Population aging is driving a rise in healthcare costs. / The aging of the population is leading to an increase in healthcare costs.
- 5 A cut in the training budget would lead to a decline in staff motivation. / Cuts to the training budget would result in lower staff morale.
- 6 Growing awareness of the sugar content of drinks has led to a decline in their consumption. / Increased public awareness of sugar levels in drinks has resulted in a fall in sales.

Check: the main action is a noun, the agent (*we, they, people*) is gone, the preposition after the noun is right (*a reduction in, a rise in, an explanation for*). In 5, the conditional becomes *would lead to*: a nice C1 move. **Appropriacy flag**: a version with four or more stacked nouns (*the reduction of the allocation of the budget for training...*) is over-nominalized: send it to Ex 5.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – BACK TO PLAIN ENGLISH (MODELS)

- 1 The reorganization aims to improve communication.
- 2 The committee considered postponing the vote.
- 3 Using the software improved the accuracy of the measurements. / The software made the measurements more accurate. (*accuracy* can sensibly stay: it names a quality.)
- 4 We'll finish repairing the elevator as soon as the new parts arrive.
- 5 Please confirm that your child will attend before the program starts.

Accept any version with working verbs and a clear agent. Items 4 and 5 should address the reader (*we, you, please*). **Not yet**: versions that change only one noun and keep "prior to the commencement of."

◆ DIALOGUE – TWO READERS, ONE FACT

Nominalizations: *summary · introduction · rise · (visitor) numbers · extension · necessity · recruitment · (the) cost*. The over-nominalized sentence is Nadia's "The extension of hours resulted in the necessity of the recruitment of additional staff." Tom fixes it first with plain verbs ("meant we had to hire"), then with a middle version: one working noun (*recruitment*) and one clear verb (*required*). Rooms: Nadia's first sentence = a chat; "The introduction of extended opening hours led to a rise in visitor numbers" = the report; "We're now open until 9 p.m.!" = the poster.

◆ SPEAKING – REGISTER WORKSHOP

Model, Round 1 (Source 1, the four-day week): "A three-month trial of a four-day working week was carried out. The results showed a 12% increase in closed support tickets and a reduction in sick leave. However, there were complaints from customers about the lack of availability on Fridays. A solution to this problem will be required before a final decision is reached." Models for all six source cards are printed small on each card (classroom materials, set C). Check the tick-boxes: 4+ nominalizations, 2 light verbs, 1 passive, 1 *there is / are*, no *I / we / they*, facts unchanged.

Model, Round 2 (Notice 1, elevator repairs): "We're still repairing the elevator. We'll finish as soon as the new parts arrive, and we'll let you know when it's working again. If you need help carrying anything heavy before then, please

call the management office." All four models are on the notice cards. The "Who does what?" test should pass instantly for every plain-English sentence.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

Which is the correct noun formed from the adjective *able*?

A) ability

B) ableness

C) ablement

Why: adjectives often take *-ity* (*stable* → *stability*), and *able* changes its spelling: *ability*. B and C are invented forms.

Q2

A friendly email says: "The facilitation of the enhancement of team communication is the objective of the reorganization." Best advice?

A) Add more nominalizations.

B) It's over-nominalized: rebalance with plain verbs.

C) Leave it: it's grammatical.

Why: four abstract nouns hide who does what, and the register is wrong for a friendly email. Better: "We're reorganizing to help the team communicate better." Grammatical (C) is not the same as appropriate.

Q3 • new

Which sentence is correct and suits a formal report?

A) ...a sharp increase of demand...

B) ...demand kind of went up a lot.

C) The survey showed a sharp increase in demand for evening classes.

Why: the noun *increase* takes *in* (A has the wrong preposition, a common transfer from *aumento de* / *augmentation de*); B uses vague spoken language in a report.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.1)

Invented nouns ("arrivement," "failure," "the deciding") · wrong preposition after the noun ("an increase of," "an impact in," "an investigation about") · process vs person nouns ("the analyst of the data") · missing or extra articles with abstract nouns ("Decision to expand led to reduction..." / "The education is important") · wrong stress on derived nouns (*STA-bi-li-ty*) · over-nominalization presented as good style · "did / made an investigation" for *carried out / conducted*. For range, praise well-controlled noun phrases (*a gradual but measurable improvement in...*) and light verbs with adjectives (*a thorough investigation*). For appropriacy, praise the learner who *chose* plain English for the notice.

3.2 · COHESION — REFERENCE, SUBSTITUTION & ELLIPSIS (C8)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE HANDOVER CALL (SCRIPT 3.2-A)

- 1 *it* = the supplier's invoice
- 2 *do it* = check the invoice
- 3 *ones* = chairs (the new chairs)
- 4 *have* = (have) sent the figures to finance
- 5 *so* = (that) the budget will be approved on Monday
- 6 *not* = (that) the delivery date will move again → "I hope it won't"
- 7 *the former* = the meeting-room order
- 8 *the latter* = the training-room order

Priya still has to **check the invoice** (tomorrow) and **deal with the meeting-room order** (urgent). The training-room order can wait. Accept any wording that shows the right target.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — REPLACE THE REPETITION

- 1 "Do you want the big suitcase or the small one?"
- 2 "You should apologize. If you fail to do so, she'll never forgive you." (also: *If you don't (do so)...*)
- 3 "I believe so."
- 4 "He was rude to a customer in public. Such behavior is unacceptable."
- 5 "We considered Chicago and Denver; we chose the latter."
- 6 "I'm afraid not."
- 7 "Energy prices doubled last winter. This increase / This rise hit small businesses hardest."

Wrong: 3 "I believe yes" · 5 "the former" (= Chicago: wrong meaning) · 6 "I'm afraid no" / "I'm not afraid so" · 7 "This hit..." (acceptable but vague; the exercise asks for a summary noun). Note in 2 that *do so* sounds formal; in speech "If you don't, ..." is more natural.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DROP IT (ELLIPSIS)

- 1 She wanted to come, but she couldn't.
- 2 I haven't seen the movie, but my brother has.
- 3 "I'd love to."
- 4 He was tired but happy.
- 5 The trip cost far more than we had expected. (also: ...*than we had expected it to.*)
- 6 The first group finished early; the second (group) did not. / ...the second didn't.

Wrong: 1 "but she couldn't come it" · 2 "but my brother has seen" (anchor + part of the verb) or "but my brother" (no anchor) · 3 "I'd love." · 6 "the second not." Point out that 6 is fine in formal writing: ordinary ellipsis works in every register.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FIX THE FAULTY REFERENCE

- 1 "The teacher praised the student's essay, and the praise / this recognition made her proud."
- 2 "There's still some milk if you want some."
- 3 "I hope not."
- 4 "He resigned suddenly, which everyone found strange. The resignation came in March." (also: *He resigned suddenly in March, which everyone found strange.*)
- 5 "I think so." (negative: "I don't think so")
- 6 "I'd love to, but I'm working."

In 1, *it* could point at the essay or the praise; a summary noun removes the doubt. In 4, *This* could point at "everyone found it strange" rather than the resignation. Accept restructured sentences that remove the ambiguity.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – A SHORT REPAIR (MODEL, 44 WORDS FROM 84)

"The office is moving to the third floor on Friday, so please pack your desk by Thursday. If you can't, tell Maria. She has boxes: large ones for files and small ones for personal items. The IT team will move the computers on Saturday."

Devices: reference (*She*), substitution (*ones* ×2), ellipsis (*If you can't*). Also fine: "...This move means...", "...and small ones for personal things." Check that no fact is lost (third floor, Friday, Thursday, Maria, two kinds of box, IT, Saturday).

◆ DIALOGUE – TWO REPORTS

Reference: *it* (the long report) · *they* (the client) · *it* (the summary). **Substitution:** *the short one / the long one · I think so · I'll do so · I'll write one · Did they?* (= Did they ask for a summary?) · *Such requests* (reference + summary). **Ellipsis:** *the long one, not yet · I didn't get to · I'll try to · I can*. The slightly formal devices for a chat between colleagues: *I'll do so* and *Such requests* (Ben is being a little playful; "I'll send them this afternoon" is more usual).

◆ SPEAKING – REPAIR THE REPORT (MODELS, 90 WORDS OR FEWER)

Report 1, the office kitchen (77 words): "The office kitchen, designed for 20 staff, is now used by 45. At lunchtime, staff wait up to 15 minutes for the two old microwaves, one of which often breaks. The fridge is always full and rarely cleaned. To solve these problems, staff have suggested buying two new microwaves and cleaning the fridge every Friday, and we recommend doing so. Both changes would make staff happier. The former would cost about \$400, which we consider reasonable."

Report 2, the composting pilot (76 words): "In April, the tenants' association started a three-month composting pilot. Thirty households put food waste in two compost bins in the back yard, producing 900 pounds of compost for the community garden. In hot weather in June, some tenants complained about the smell. Once the bins were moved away from the windows, these complaints stopped. The association wants to continue the pilot and add two more bins. If the landlord agrees, it will do so in September."

Report 3, the customer survey (87 words): "In May, Spoke & Chain Bike Repair surveyed 120 customers about prices, speed and service. Most were happy with the first and the last, but many were not with the speed: repairs took an average of six days, while customers want them to take two or three. Some suggested an online booking system, which would let them book a repair time; others, longer opening hours. The owner likes the former but not the latter, which would cost too much, and will introduce online booking in the summer."

"Point at it" check for Report 3: *the former* = online booking, *the latter* = longer hours, *which* = longer hours. If a group writes "It would cost too much" after mentioning both options, flag the *it*. Also accept participle clauses and other C1 compression (*producing 900 pounds*) even though they aren't cohesion devices.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

"Tenants must vacate by June. Those who fail to ____ will face penalties." Which fits a formal notice best?

A) do it

B) make so

C) do so

Why: *do so* replaces a stated verb phrase (*vacate by June*) in formal writing. *do it* is concrete and conversational; *make so* doesn't exist.

Q2

Which sentence uses ellipsis correctly and naturally?

A) "I haven't read the memo, but Sara has."

B) "Would you like to stay?" — "I'd love."

C) "She can swim, and she can also swim well."

Why: the auxiliary *has* stays as the anchor. B drops the anchor *to*; C has no ellipsis and sounds odd (*She can swim, and well, too*).

Q3 · new

"Will the shipment be delayed again?" You don't want a delay.

A) I don't hope so.

B) I hope not.

C) I hope no.

Why: *hope* and *be afraid* make the negative with **not** after the verb. *think*, *believe*, *expect* usually negate the verb (*I don't think so*), but *I don't hope so* is unnatural. C is a transfer from *espero que no*.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.2)

"I think yes / I hope no / I don't hope so" · "a coffee one / a milk one / the advices ones" · "I'd love." / "but Sara." (no anchor) · vague *it* / *this* pointing at two possible ideas · gendered *he* / *she* for things ("the proposal... she is too expensive") · dropped subjects and objects ("Is very expensive." "I bought the report and read.") · *the former* / *the latter* in casual speech · "I did so" in a chat where "I did" is natural. For range, praise *this* / *such* + *summary noun*, *those who fail to do so* in writing, and fluent spoken ellipsis (*I meant to, but I didn't get to*).

3.3 · HEDGING, VAGUE LANGUAGE & DIPLOMATIC ENGLISH (C9)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – FEEDBACK ON A DRAFT (SCRIPT 3.3-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
a couple of thoughts	really solid	maybe a bit long	I wonder if	not entirely convinced	might be worth	Would it be possible

Dev must: **cut the events section to five**, **rethink the headline** (ask the volunteers), and **send a new version by Thursday**. This is the point of the exercise: the feedback is soft but completely clear.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – SOFTEN THE BLUNT STATEMENTS (MODELS; MANY ANSWERS POSSIBLE)

- 1 "There are just a few small things in the report I think we could tighten up."
- 2 "I'm afraid I won't be able to help with this one. The thing is, I'm really stretched this week. Could you ask Maya?"
- 3 "I see what you mean, though I'm not entirely convinced. Could it also be that...?"
- 4 "Would it be possible to send me the file when you get a moment?"
- 5 "I'm a little concerned the deadline might be tight. Would it be possible to push it back a week, or to reduce the scope?"
- 6 "Unfortunately, we're not able to offer a discount on this order. The thing is, our prices already include delivery. We could perhaps look at a discount on your next order, though."

Check: at least one softener (distancing, minimizer, preface) **and** the message is still there. **Not yet:** "Please give me the file now" (still an order) · "Maybe the report has some little problems, possibly" (vague and over-hedged) · 5 "You must change the deadline" (too strong to a manager).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – HEDGE THE OVER-STRONG CLAIMS (MODELS)

- 1 "This study suggests that remote work may increase productivity, at least in some contexts."
- 2 "Many learners seem to benefit from visual aids, to some extent." / "Visual aids appear to help a large number of learners."
- 3 "There is some evidence that online courses may be less effective than classroom teaching for some learners, although results vary considerably."
- 4 "Moderate coffee consumption appears to improve concentration in the short term for many people."

Look for two devices from different families (modal + verb, verb + adverbial, frame + modal). **Over-hedged** (flag it): "It could perhaps possibly be argued that coffee might arguably sometimes help some people to some extent." **Wrong register:** "Coffee sort of helps you concentrate."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – WHICH TOOLKIT?

1 **H** (report, essay) · 2 **D** (spoken or written request) · 3 **V** (casual conversation) · 4 **H** (formal writing) · 5 **D** (neutral-formal request) · 6 **V** (casual; *like* and *or so*) · 7 **D** (meeting: polite disagreement) · 8 **H** (academic writing)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WHAT DO THEY REALLY MEAN?

1 **b** · 2 **d** · 3 **a** · 4 **e** · 5 **c**

5 is the one learners underestimate: "a slight issue" can signal a serious problem, especially in British English. Tone and context decide.

◆ DIALOGUE – A REQUEST, A REFUSAL, AN ALTERNATIVE

Omar's **preface:** "Ah. As much as I'd like to, I'm afraid..." · **soften:** "Thursday's not going to work" · **reason:** "The thing is, I'm with a client all afternoon." · **alternative:** "Perhaps we could ask Jin instead? ... Or couldn't we record a short

video?" and "I'm happy to help you record it on Wednesday." **Distancing:** "I was wondering if you could do me a favor" · "Would it be possible for you to...?" **Negative questions:** "couldn't we record a short video?" · "Wouldn't it be worth asking?" Also: minimizer "a bit of a problem" and litotes-style "I'm not entirely sure."

◆ SPEAKING – DIPLOMATIC ROLE-PLAY SERIES (MODEL TURNS FOR A)

① **Bad news (v1):** "I'm afraid I have some difficult news about the brochures. Unfortunately, our paper supplier is running late, so the full order won't be ready until the 18th, not the 4th. I know that's not what you were hoping to hear, especially with the event on the 10th. What we can do is have 500 copies printed locally by the 4th, at no extra cost, and deliver the rest on the 18th. Would that work for you?"

② **Disagreeing with a manager (v1):** "I can see why next week is attractive, especially with the competitor's launch. With respect, I'm not entirely convinced the app is ready yet. In testing we saw double bookings, and I'd be worried about the effect on customers. Would it be possible to test it with fifty real customers for two more weeks? Or couldn't we launch to a small group first?"

③ **Declining (v2):** "Thanks for thinking of me. I'd really like to help, but I'm afraid I can't take on a third project right now. The thing is, the Harris report is due on Friday. I could start in two weeks, or, if another deadline can move, I could take on the data cleaning. Would either of those work?"

④ **Feedback (v1):** "Can I share a couple of thoughts on the slides? The content's really strong, and the chart on slide 3 is excellent. One thing I'd suggest is that some slides are a bit crowded, so the audience might struggle to follow. I wonder if we could keep each slide to about thirty words and move the detail into a handout? I'm happy to look at it with you tomorrow."

"What must change?" test, target sentences for B: ① "I'll get 500 on the 4th and the rest on the 18th." · ② "We'll test for two more weeks / launch to a small group first." · ③ "You can't start this week, but you can start in two weeks or do the data cleaning." · ④ "Thirty words or fewer per slide and a handout." If B's sentence doesn't match, discuss what was missing, usually the message or the alternative.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

A colleague proposes a risky plan. Which reply is the most diplomatically softened?

A) "That won't work. It's too risky."

B) "It's sort of risky and stuff."

C) "I wonder if it might be a bit risky — it might be worth thinking through the downside first?"

Why: C uses a tentative frame (*I wonder if*), a modal (*might*), a minimizer (*a bit*) and a constructive suggestion. A is blunt; B is vague casual language, not diplomacy, and gives no direction.

Q2

Which sentence belongs in a formal academic essay?

A) "It kind of helped, twenty or so people improved and stuff."

B) "The data suggest that the intervention may improve outcomes to some extent."

C) "I was wondering if you could re-run the numbers?"

Why: B hedges with a lexical verb, a modal and an adverbial. A is vague language (casual speech); C is diplomatic distancing (a polite request), not an academic claim.

Q3 · new

Your manager asks you to take on a third project, but you're overloaded. Which reply protects the relationship and gives a clear answer?

A) "No. I have too much work."

B) "I'd really like to help, but I'm afraid I can't take on another project right now. The thing is, the Harris report is due on Friday. Could we look at it again next month?"

C) "Hmm, that might be a little bit tricky, maybe, possibly... we'll see."

Why: B follows preface → soften → reason → alternative. A is clear but blunt; C is so soft that the manager may think the answer is yes.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.3)

"I want that you send it" · "Please give me the file" as a polite request · "Can you to check...?" · "You must change this" to a manager · "You're coming, isn't it?" · "maybe" as the only hedge · over-hedging until the claim disappears · vague language in writing ("The results were sort of significant") · refusals so soft the listener hears a yes · stressing the minimizer sarcastically ("It's a **BIT** late") · flat intonation that undoes polite words. For range, praise *I'd have thought...*, *not exactly ideal*, *Would it be at all possible...*, *With respect* used sincerely, and stacked hedges that stay clear (*appears to... to some extent*).

Module 4 — Lexical Range & Fluency: Answers

Answers to every Module 4 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the Register Swap update, the Precise Talk, the Advanced Communicator talk plan and written summary), and the errors you can expect to hear and read most.

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **accuracy, range and appropriacy**. In a lexical module, many items have more than one good answer: accept any answer that is **natural** (an expert user would say it), **precise** (it means exactly what the context needs) and **appropriate** (the register and connotation fit the reader). Where a learner's answer is correct but a different choice from the key, accept it and ask for the reason: "Good. Why that one here?" A good reason is the C1 skill. American English is the model; British spellings and forms (*grey, programme, nominalisation, take a decision*) are acceptable when a learner uses them. In the register exercises, mark the **whole sentence**: a formal verb in an otherwise chatty sentence is a clash, even if every word is correct.

4.1 • PHRASAL VERBS & MULTI-WORD VERBS (C10)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE VOICE MESSAGE (SCRIPT 4.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
fell through	pulled out	put it off	set up	held up	picked up	look into	cut down on
①	①	②	②	①	①	③	④

5 and 6 are intransitive here (*the team held up · things picked up*), although both verbs are separable in other senses (*hold up a bank / pick up a friend*): a good polysemy moment. **Retell formally:** *fell through* → *was nearly abandoned* · *pulled out* → *withdrew* · *put it off* → *postponed it* · *look into* → *investigate* · *cut down on* → *reduce*. Extra phrasal verbs to notice in the script: *taken off, backed out, caught out*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PLACE THE OBJECT

- 1 Could you turn it down? (~~turn down it~~)
- 2 She looks after her on weekends. (~~looks her after~~)
- 3 Please fill it in. (also *fill it out*, very common in American English)

- 4 I can't put up with it any longer.
- 5 We need to deal with them today.
- 6 He threw them away.
- 7 Have you gotten over it yet? (inseparable: ~~gotten it over~~) · British: *got over it*
- 8 They called it off.

b) A: a long ("heavy") object goes at the end, keeping the verb and particle together; in B the listener waits too long for *off*. **Wrong:** any pronoun after a separable particle (1, 3, 6, 8); any pronoun between an inseparable verb and its preposition (2, 5, 7).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE REGISTER SWAP

a) 1 e (postpone) · 2 i (discover) · 3 c (investigate) · 4 g (increase) · 5 h (establish) · 6 f (abandon) · 7 a (tolerate) · 8 j (conduct) · 9 d (eliminate) · 10 b (encounter)

b)

- 1 **look into:** a text to a roommate is spoken register; *investigate* sounds like a police report.
- 2 **postponed:** a formal letter from an institution.
- 3 **either:** *carry out* is one of the phrasal verbs that is fully at home in formal writing; *conducted* is slightly more formal. Accept both with this reason; this is the "don't over-correct" item.
- 4 **give up:** *relinquish* over coffee is absurdly formal.
- 5 **rose:** a single-word verb suits academic writing (*increased* is also good).
- 6 **encounter:** formal customer-service register. Accept *come across* if the learner argues for a warmer, neutral email; the reason matters.
- 7 **get rid of:** a quick spoken team meeting.

c) **Model:** "We have discovered that the heating failed because the annual inspection had not been carried out, and we have therefore established a new maintenance schedule." Also accept *had not been conducted*, *broke down* → *failed* / *malfunctioned*, a nominalized version ("Investigation revealed that the heating failure resulted from the omission of the annual inspection; a new schedule has consequently been established."). **Wrong:** leaving *found out* or *set up* in an otherwise formal sentence is a mild clash rather than an error; *carried out* may stay.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ONE VERB, MANY MEANINGS

a iv (leave the ground) · b vi (become successful) · c ii (remove clothing) · d viii (deduct) · e ix (collect someone) · f v (learn informally) · g i (improve) · h vii (manage to see) · i iii (claim, probably falsely)

In d, *take 15% off* separates around a long object; in i, *make out that...* introduces a clause and carries doubt. Point out that the collocates decide the meaning: *flight*, *podcast*, *shoes*, *price*.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM VERB TO NOUN

1 **breakdown** · 2 **takeover** · 3 **outbreak** · 4 **outcome** · 5 **input** · 6 **setback** · 7 **turnout** (all first-syllable stress; all one word)

Wrong: "a break down," "the take over," "an out come" (spacing), "a break-out of flu" (the noun flips: *outbreak*). *Turnout* is the usual word for attendance at events and elections.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE LAUNCH, IN TWO REGISTERS

Phrasal verbs (16): *fell through* · *pulled out* · *put (it) off* · *set up* · *hold up* · *put up with* · *burned out* · *picked up* · *came back* · *taken off* · *find out* · *backed out* · *looked into* · *(turns out)* · *taken over* · *cut down on* · *get caught out*. **Formal twins:** *fell through* → (nearly) abandoned · *pulled out* → withdrew · *put off* → postpone · *set up* → establish · *put up with* → tolerated · *looked into* → investigating · *found out* → discovered · *taken over* → acquired. **Could have stayed:** *set up* (fine in formal business writing) and arguably *look into* in a neutral report; *takeover* as a noun is standard business English ("following a takeover by a competitor"). Accept any with a reason.

◆ SPEAKING – THE REGISTER SWAP (MODEL UPDATE)

Model (Story 1, the community center leak; 84 words): "Following reports of water damage in the main hall, the facilities team investigated the matter on Monday and discovered that a pipe beneath the kitchen had deteriorated. Repairs have been postponed until Thursday so that a licensed plumber can carry out (K) the work safely. In the meantime, the hall will remain closed, and Saturday's classes have been relocated to the library. We apologize for the inconvenience and appreciate the patience of all users. A full report will follow." **Check:** 70–90 words, at least one kept phrasal verb with a reason (*carry out* is standard in formal writing), no idioms, pronouns placed correctly, consistent register.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

The light is still on. Which is correct?

A) Could you turn off it?

B) Could you turn it off?

C) Could you turn it off from?

Why: *turn off* is separable, and a pronoun object must go between the verb and the particle. A breaks the pronoun rule; C adds a stray preposition (*turn off* is not a three-part verb).

Q2

In a formal written report, which best replaces "we'll look into the complaint"?

A) we will look up the complaint

B) we will put up with the complaint

C) we will investigate the complaint

Why: *investigate* is the formal single-word twin of *look into*. A changes the meaning (*look up* = search for information) and is still informal; B means *tolerate*.

Q3 · new

Which sentence uses the three-part verb correctly?

A) I can't put up it with any longer.

B) I can't put up with it any longer.

C) I can't put it up with any longer.

Why: three-part verbs are never split, even by a pronoun: the object follows both particles. (*Put it up* exists, but it means "raise / display it," a different verb.)

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR AND READ MOST (4.1)

"Turn off it." · "Pick up her at six." · "Look the kids after." · "Put up it with." · "a break down" (noun spacing) · "look forward to see you" · "discuss about the plan" · over-formal speech ("I will investigate where I left my keys," "Shall we commence?") and phrasal verbs in formal letters ("We will sort out your refund"). The pronoun error is the priority: correct it every time, in speech too. For range, praise noun forms (*the outcome, a setback*), polysemy used well (*business picked up*) and a justified K.

4.2 · COLLOCATION, IDIOM & CONNOTATION (C11)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE TEAM MEETING (SCRIPT 4.2-A)

Heard (8): the last straw · cut corners · hit the nail on the head · the tip of the iceberg · a blessing in disguise · on the same page · food for thought · bite the bullet. **Not heard:** get cold feet · a gray area.

Meanings (accept any accurate paraphrase): the last straw = the final problem that makes a situation unbearable · cut corners = do something cheaply or quickly and lose quality · hit the nail on the head = describe a problem exactly · the tip of the iceberg = a small visible part of a much bigger problem · a blessing in disguise = something that seems bad but turns out well · on the same page = in agreement, sharing an understanding · food for thought = something

worth thinking about seriously · bite the bullet = make yourself do something difficult or unpleasant. **Decision:** tell the board they need another month; Sam will write the email **formally, without idioms**.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COLLOCATION GRIDS

make	a decision · a mistake
do	research
take	a photo · a risk (also British <i>take a decision</i>)
pay	attention · a compliment
raise	an issue
meet	a deadline

deeply	concerned · disappointed · (respected: accept)
highly	unlikely · regarded · respected
bitterly	cold · disappointed
fully	aware
widely	regarded · respected

Wrong (the famous traps): "make research," "do a decision," "make a photo," "do a mistake," "make attention," "strongly unlikely," "deeply cold." Also correct but not in the grid: *raise a concern / a question / awareness, miss / extend a deadline, widely known*.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FROM WEAK TO STRONG

- 1 bitterly cold (also *freezing cold*)
- 2 highly unlikely
- 3 deeply concerned (also *deeply worried, gravely concerned* in formal writing)
- 4 apologized profusely
- 5 heavy traffic
- 6 a bitter disappointment
- 7 gave a long round of applause (also *gave a standing ovation* if they stood)
- 8 a key / pressing / major issue

Wrong: "strongly cold," "heavily unlikely," "big traffic," "a heavy disappointment," "apologized strongly."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CHOOSE THE SHADE AND THE REGISTER

a) 1 slender · slim · thin · skinny · scrawny · 2 thrifty · frugal · economical · tight · stingy · 3 curious · inquisitive · interested · nosy

Accept either order inside the positive pair and inside the negative pair (*slender / slim*, *thrifty / frugal*, *tight / stingy*). *Frugal* can sound more austere than *thrifty*; *inquisitive* can tip toward prying ("inquisitive neighbors"). A learner who notices this deserves praise.

b) 1 self-assured · 2 require · 3 thrifty · 4 notorious · 5 get going · 6 childlike · 7 nosy · 8 determined

Each alternative would jar: *arrogant* insults, *want* is too blunt for a formal email, *stingy* criticizes, *renowned* celebrates crime, *commence* is absurd over lunch, *childish* insults the retiree, *curious* is too kind for the complaint, *stubborn* would damage a reference.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – IDIOMS: FIX THEM, OR REPHRASE THEM

a) 1 hit the nail on **the** head · 2 a blessing in disguise (no *the*) · 3 on the same **page** · 4 got cold **feet** · 5 the **tip** of the iceberg

b) **Models:**

- 1 The complaints represent only a small fraction of the problem.
- 2 The contractor compromised safety standards in order to reduce costs. / The contractor failed to follow the required safety procedures.
- 3 The regulations on this matter are unclear. / This remains a legally ambiguous area.
- 4 The board eventually took the difficult decision to raise the fees. / The board reluctantly raised the fees.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE COMMUNITY GARDEN FENCE

Strong collocations: *deeply concerned* · *highly unlikely* · *cover (all of) it* / *cover the cost* · *do (some) research* · *a calculated risk* · *raise the issue* · *make a decision* · *meet the (grant) deadline*. **Idiom:** *bite the bullet*. **Mr. Ali:** Rosa calls him *frugal* and *thrifty* (admiring; he spends carefully); Ken calls him *the stingiest man on the block* (critical, half-joking). Same behavior, opposite judgment: the whole lesson in one exchange.

◆ SPEAKING – THE PRECISE TALK (MODEL OPENING)

Model (topic: a place I know well): "The market in my old neighborhood is widely regarded as the best in the city, and on a bitterly cold Saturday morning it's still packed. What struck me, though, when I went back last year, was how many stalls had closed. Rents have risen sharply, and several families took a calculated risk by moving online. For some it paid off handsomely; for others it was a bitter disappointment. Honestly, the empty stalls are just the tip of the iceberg..." **Shades:** "In a travel article I'd call the market *renowned*; in a complaint to the city about parking, *notorious*." Check: 6+ strong collocations, 1–2 idioms that fit, register consistent, a near-synonym set explained with both connotation and register.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which sentence uses the natural English collocations?

A) There was heavy traffic, so we had to make a quick decision.

B) There was strong traffic, so we had to make a quick decision.

C) There was heavy traffic, so we had to do a quick decision.

Why: *heavy traffic* and *make a decision* are both fixed partnerships. B uses "strong traffic"; C uses "do a decision."

Q2

You want to compliment a friend who is careful and sensible with money. Which word fits the connotation?

A) thrifty

B) stingy

C) tight

Why: all three describe careful spending, but only *thrifty* is positive. *Stingy* and *tight* criticize someone for being unwilling to spend or share.

Q3 · new

An invented coworker keeps asking about everyone's salary and private life. Which word expresses your critical view?

A) curious

B) inquisitive

C) nosy

Why: *nosy* is the negative end of the cline: too interested in things that are none of your business. *Curious* is positive or neutral; *inquisitive* is mostly positive (an inquisitive mind).

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR AND READ MOST (4.2)

"make a photo" · "do a mistake" · "make research" · "strong rain" · "win money" (salary) · "strongly unlikely" · "very bitterly cold" (stacked intensifiers) · "hit the nail on its head" · "a blessing in the disguise" · idioms in formal writing · three idioms in one breath · positive intent with a negative word ("My friend is so skinny, she looks great"). *make / do* is the priority: correct it every time. For range, praise noun + noun chunks (*a pang of guilt*, *a flurry of activity*), verb + adverb (*apologized profusely*) and a well-judged *absence* of idioms in writing.

4.3 · REVIEW PROJECT — THE ADVANCED COMMUNICATOR (C12)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE MODEL TALK AND Q&A (SCRIPT 4.3-A)

a) Ask yourself this (1) · I'd like to make the case that (2) · There are three points I want to raise (3) · Let me begin by (4) · This brings me to (5) · Turning now to (6) · In essence (7) · I take your point, but I'd argue (8) · That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is (9)

b) Heard:

future perfect	the scheme will have paid for itself
subjunctive	it is essential that the day be protected
mixed conditional	Had we offered something like this five years ago, we would not now be losing...
not only inversion	Not only does a learning day show staff that they are valued, but it also...
what-cleft	What we need is not another annual course, but...
nominalization	The introduction of a learning day is a small change...
hedging	The evidence would appear to suggest...
strong collocation	a pressing concern (also <i>staff turnover</i> , <i>a large return</i>)

Not heard: *needn't have*; ellipsis with *so / not*. Also notice: a contrast (*not another annual course, but a steady habit*), a rule of three in the preview (*skills, loyalty and cost*), phrasal verbs kept in a persuasive talk (*look into, kept up*).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – SHIFT THE REGISTER (MODELS)

- 1 "It is important that we address the financial implications at the earliest opportunity."
- 2 "Any chance you could send me those documents?"
- 3 "There are some real problems here that we'll need to resolve."
- 4 "The new schedule will be introduced in March and is expected to reduce overtime."
- 5 "Everyone's got to be there, no exceptions, or you could get in trouble."

Answers will vary. Check that **vocabulary, voice and sentence shape** all match the target: 1 and 4 need nominal or passive structures and no contractions; 2 and 5 need contractions and everyday words; 3 is the middle (*we'll* is fine, *total mess* is not). Also accept for 1: *The financial aspects will need to be discussed shortly*.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – NAME THE DEVICE

1 rule of three / parallelism · 2 contrast (antithesis) · 3 *what-cleft* (fronting for emphasis) · 4 rhetorical question · 5 deliberate repetition (anaphora), also a rule of three · 6 negative inversion

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REPAIR THE REGISTER CLASH (MODELS)

- 1 Formal: "The board will convene on Thursday to resolve the outstanding issues." / Informal: "The board's meeting Thursday to sort out the mess."
- 2 Formal: "I have serious reservations about the aforementioned proposal." / Informal: "I think that proposal's pretty sketchy."
- 3 Neutral: "Hi team, following up on our discussion, should we meet to talk it through?"
- 4 "Dear Ms. Patel, Thank you for your application. Unfortunately, we are unable to offer you the position."
- 5 Formal: "The quarterly figures indicate a substantial decline in revenue." / Informal: "So basically, we made a lot less money this quarter."

The key is **consistency**: pick a register and align every feature to it. In 4, the direction is fixed by the genre (a rejection letter must be formal and kind).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – UPGRADE WITH THE TOOLKIT

- 1 By the end of 2028, the scheme will have paid for itself.
- 2 It is essential that every employee complete the training. (British and acceptable: ...*completes* / *should complete*; the C1 target is the subjunctive.)
- 3 If we had invested in training, we wouldn't be short of skilled staff now. / Had we invested in training, we would not now be short of skilled staff.
- 4 Not only is the plan cheap, but it is also effective.
- 5 What we need is time, not money. / It is time, not money, that we need.
- 6 The introduction of the policy led to a sharp fall in waste. / ...resulted in a marked reduction in waste.
- 7 This would appear to suggest that the scheme works. / This may indicate that the scheme is effective.
- 8 We will investigate the reasons for the sharp increase in costs.

Wrong: 1 "will be paid for itself" · 2 "that every employee completes" is not wrong, but tick M1 only for the subjunctive · 3 "If we hadn't invested... we wouldn't be" (reversed logic), "Had we invested... we wouldn't have been short now" (time mismatch) · 4 "Not only the plan is cheap" (no inversion) · 7 "This proves perhaps..." (hedge in the wrong place).

◆ DIALOGUE – ONE POINT, TWO VOICES

Features that shift together (any five): *would respectfully suggest* ↔ *Look, between us* · *hedged may well prove prudent* ↔ *blunt there's no way* · *nominal some compromise to quality* ↔ *phrasal/idiomatic cutting corners* · *a modest extension* ↔ *push it back a week* · *it is by no means certain* ↔ *we're* (contractions) · *quality must remain paramount* ↔ *a false economy* · *participle clause Having reviewed...* ↔ *short simple clauses* · *no tag* ↔ *OK?*

◆ SPEAKING & WRITING – THE ADVANCED COMMUNICATOR

Talk planner (model: a paid learning day). Open: *Ask yourself this: when did you last learn something new at work because someone gave you the time?* · Preview: skills, loyalty, cost · Point 1: tools change faster than training (*What we need is...*) · Point 2: turnover is a pressing concern (*Had we offered..., we would not now be...*) · Point 3: the cost is recovered (*will have paid for itself; it is essential that the day be protected*) · Close: *In essence, the choice is a simple one.* · Q&A: small businesses can't spare staff → stagger the day; staff will treat it as a day off → a short written note after each day.

Model written summary (155 words): "This proposal argues that employers in the region should offer every member of staff one paid learning day per month. The principal justification is the widening skills gap: as workplace technology evolves, regular, protected learning time would appear to be more effective than an annual training course. A further benefit would be improved staff retention, since employees are more likely to remain with an organization that invests in their development. It was argued during the discussion that small businesses may be unable to release staff for a full day. In response, it is proposed that learning days be staggered across each team, so that no more than one employee is absent at any time. A second concern, that the day might be treated as additional leave, could be addressed by requiring a brief written record of what was learned. On balance, the introduction of the scheme represents a modest cost with a potentially substantial return."

Check (W1–W4): proposal in sentence 1 · two supported reasons · objection reported fairly with a reporting verb (*It was argued...*, *One participant questioned whether...*) · a response · consistently formal (nominalization: *the introduction of the scheme*; hedging: *would appear to, potentially*; subjunctive: *be staggered*) · no idioms, contractions or rhetorical questions.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A speaker wants to draw listeners in and make them supply the answer themselves. Which device fits?

A) Nominalization ("the implementation of the plan")

B) Ellipsis ("some agreed, others didn't")

C) A rhetorical question ("Can we really afford to wait?")

Why: a rhetorical question invites the listener to answer silently ("No, we can't"), so they arrive at the speaker's point themselves. A is a formal-register tool; B is a cohesion tool.

Q2

Which sentence best combines a formal register with the subjunctive to express urgent necessity?

A) We really need to do something about this soon.

B) It is imperative that action be taken at once.

C) It's imperative that action is taken pronto.

Why: *be taken* is the (passive) subjunctive after *it is imperative that*, and every other feature is formal. A is informal and has no subjunctive; C uses the indicative and clashes (*it's*, *pronto* with *imperative*).

Q3 · new

Which sentence keeps a consistent formal register?

A) The committee will sort out the discrepancies.

B) The committee will resolve the discrepancies.

C) The committee's gonna resolve the discrepancies.

Why: *committee* and *discrepancies* set a formal register; *resolve* matches it. A drops an informal phrasal verb into it; C clashes with *gonna* and a contraction.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR AND READ MOST (4.3)

Register clash inside one sentence ("The committee will sort out...", "Hey team, pursuant to...") · the whole talk in the formal register with no warmth · idioms and contractions in the written summary · rhetoric overload (three rhetorical questions in a row) · "Not only it is..." (no inversion) · "It is essential that he is told" (acceptable, but not the C1 target) · "Resuming..." / "According to me,..." · countering without conceding in the Q&A · signpost-free rambling. For range, praise a well-placed cleft or inversion at a hinge, a fair and precise report of the objection in writing, and a deliberate, justified register shift.

Module 5 — Structure & Advanced Vocabulary: Answers

Answers to every Module 5 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, the classroom-materials answers (Dangler Hunt, model condensed reports, the Correction Challenge email, model replies and summaries, The Editor's Path), and the errors you can expect to hear and read most.

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **accuracy, range and appropriacy**. An answer is correct if the meaning is preserved (no fact lost in compression, no claim stronger than the source), the form is right (participle chosen by voice; the participle's implied subject matches the main subject or has its own; the exact dependent preposition; *-ing* after a preposition; the academic word in its correct sense), and the register suits the context. Be generous about **genuine alternatives**: several compressions, several academic equivalents (*obtain / acquire, examine / investigate*), *regarding / with regard to / concerning, the data suggest / suggests*, and "being" kept or dropped in an absolute (*The meeting (being) over*). A compression that is correct but less elegant is still correct: note an upgrade, don't deduct. American English is the model; British forms (*realise, analyse, cancelled, programme, enquiry, in the light of, towards*) are acceptable when a learner uses them.

5.1 • PARTICIPLE & ABSOLUTE CLAUSES (C14)

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 RETURN – "LET'S FIX IT!" (BOARD ERRORS)

Not only did she finish the report, but she also presented it. (inversion after a fronted negative: auxiliary before subject) • If I had accepted the offer, I **would be living / would live** in Boston now. (mixed conditional: past condition → present result; or keep "by now" with *would have been living in Boston for a year by now*) • It was in 2019 **that** she moved to Denver. (*it*-cleft uses *that*, even for time) • We need to **do (some) research** before the meeting. (*research* is uncountable; *do / conduct* research) • Extras: She must have **forgotten** the password. • Hardly had I sat down **when** the phone rang. (or *No sooner had I sat down than...*) • The manager insisted that every employee **attend**. (mandative subjunctive; *attends* and *should attend* are normal in British English, so accept them)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE CHAIR'S ANNOUNCEMENT (SCRIPT 5.1-A)

1	2	3	4
Having reviewed	the gymnasium being unavailable	wishing to run	printed for the fair
5	6	7	8

The schedule being unusually full	Weather permitting	All things considered	Having said that
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Own subject: 2 (*the gymnasium being unavailable*) and 5 (*the schedule being unusually full*). Also accept 6 (*weather permitting* is technically an absolute) if the learner explains it. Spelling slips (*reveiwed, permitting*) don't lose the point in a listening task; *Having review or printing for the fair* do (wrong form).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPRESS EACH SENTENCE

- 1 **Knowing** the area well, ... (reason, active)
- 2 **Having locked** the door, ... (earlier action)
- 3 **Written in a hurry**, the report... (passive → past participle)
- 4 The volunteers **helping** at the fair... (reduced relative)
- 5 **Not having received** a reply, ... (also: *Having not received*, common but less standard; *Not receiving* is acceptable)
- 6 **Taken** as directed, ... (also: *If taken as directed*)

Wrong: 3 "Writing in a hurry" (the report didn't write) · 6 "Taking as directed" · 2 "Locking the door" is understandable but loses the sequence; accept with an upgrade note.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DOES THE SUBJECT DO IT, OR RECEIVE IT?

- 1 **Checked** twice, the figures... (the figures were checked)
- 2 **Having interviewed** all the candidates, the panel... (the panel interviewed, earlier)
- 3 Any passengers **traveling** without a ticket... (they travel: active reduced relative)
- 4 **Founded** in 1992, the co-op... (someone founded it)
- 5 ..., **destroying** three bridges. (result; the flood destroyed them)
- 6 **Having been told** about the delay, the passengers... (they were told: perfect passive)

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ABSOLUTE CLAUSES

- 1 **The funds having run out**, the project was suspended.
- 2 **The last guest gone / having left**, the hosts sank into their chairs.
- 3 **The speeches over / (being) over**, the music began. (also: *The speeches having ended, ...*)
- 4 She presented the plan, **her voice calm and steady**. (also: *her voice being calm and steady*, heavier; or *with her voice calm and steady*)

Wrong: "Having run out, the project was suspended" (dangles: the project didn't run out) · "Being over the speeches, ..." (word order) · "Gone the last guest, ..." (Romance word order).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SOUND OR DANGLING?

- 1 S (she missed the bus; she walked)
- 2 D → Rushing to the station, **we found** the train had already left. / **By the time we reached** the station, the train had already left.
- 3 S (the library was opened)
- 4 D → Looking out of the office window, **I could clearly see** the new park. / **From the office window**, the new park was clearly visible.
- 5 S (fixed phrase, exempt from subject-matching)
- 6 D → After signing the lease, **we felt** at home in the apartment at last. / **Once we had signed** the lease, the apartment finally felt like home. / **The lease signed**, the apartment finally felt like home.

◆ DIALOGUE TASK

Dangling: "Reading the report, several errors jumped out at me." · Fixed phrase: "Having said that" (also "All things considered") · Absolute: "The budget approved, work began in May."

◆ WORKSHOP, ROUND 1 – DANGLER HUNT (SET B STRIPS)

Strip	Verdict	Model repair
1	Dangling	Having reviewed the budget, the committee found the proposal too expensive.
2	Sound	(the center was built in 1968)
3	Dangling	Walking through the new wing, we noticed an overwhelming smell of fresh paint. / As we walked through the new wing, ...
4	Sound	(absolute clause with its own subject: <i>the funding</i>)
5	Dangling	Delayed by the storm, the delivery was rescheduled (by the manager). / The delivery having been delayed by the storm, the manager rescheduled it.
6	Sound	(fixed phrase)
7	Dangling	This being a public building, visitors must sign in. / Because this is a public building, ...
8	Dangling	After finishing the survey, the team posted the results online. / The survey finished , the results were posted online.

Strip 5 is the subtle one: a manager can be "delayed by a storm," so some teams will call it sound. Ask: "What did the storm delay, the manager or the delivery?" Accept "sound" only if the team argues convincingly that the manager

was delayed, then point out the ambiguity: in formal writing, ambiguity is itself a reason to rewrite.

◆ WORKSHOP, ROUND 2 – MODEL CONDENSED REPORTS (FOR THE TEACHER, NOT A TARGET TO COPY)

Report 1 • Library Wi-Fi (124 → 90 words): *Meeting on May 3, the library board reviewed the results of the Wi-Fi upgrade. Completed in April and funded by a city grant, the new system, designed by a local firm, supports up to 200 users; the old routers, installed in 2012, handled only 40. Having examined the figures, the board noted a 70 percent fall in complaints. The budget not having been fully spent, it decided to extend the service to the garden terrace from June, weather permitting. It thanked the staff who had worked evenings during the installation.*

Report 2 • Night bus (115 → 86 words): *Its buses running every 30 minutes, the city's three-month Route 12 night-bus pilot connected the hospital, the university and the industrial park. Many riders working late shifts, the transit office had expected strong demand. The pilot over, it surveyed 400 riders; carried out by university students, the survey found that 82 percent felt safer. Ridership having exceeded the target, the office has recommended a permanent service from September, provided that the council approves the funding. It thanked the drivers who had volunteered for the late shifts.* Trap: "Running every 30 minutes, the pilot connected..." dangles (the buses ran, not the pilot).

Report 3 • Clinic text alerts (125 → 88 words): *Tested for six weeks in the Hillside Clinic waiting room, a text-alert system let checked-in patients leave the building, texting them when the doctor was ready. The waiting room having often been overcrowded, staff had received many complaints. The trial over, an outside consultant analyzed the clinic's data, finding that average waiting-room time fell from 38 to 11 minutes. Patients having responded positively, the clinic will keep the system and, provided that the software company agrees, extend it to the pharmacy. It thanked the patients who had taken part.*

What counts as success: 90 words or fewer, all facts present, four or more constructions (one absolute), one fixed phrase (*weather permitting, provided that, given that*), no dangles. Keeping a relative clause (*who had volunteered*) is a sound choice: the past perfect meaning is clearer than in a reduced form. A team at 95 words with a clear text has done well.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which sentence contains a dangling participle?

A) Having missed the bus, she walked to work.

B) Rushing to the station, the train had already left.

C) Built in 1850, the house needs repairs.

Why: the person rushing is implied, but the main subject is *the train*, which can't rush to catch itself. A attaches correctly to *she*; C attaches correctly to *the house*, which was built.

Q2

You want to compress "Because the road was blocked, the drivers turned back," but the two clauses have different subjects.

A) The road blocked, the drivers turned back.

B) Blocking the road, the drivers turned back.

C) Being blocked the road, the drivers turned back.

Why: an absolute clause gives the participle its own subject (*the road*), so nothing dangles. B dangles and reverses the meaning (the drivers blocked the road); C is not grammatical.

Q3 · new

Which sentence is both correct and properly anchored?

A) Damaging in transit, the package was returned to the sender.

B) Damaged in transit, the sender returned the package.

C) Damaged in transit, the package was returned to the sender.

Why: the package was damaged (passive → past participle) and *the package* is the next subject. A uses -ing for a passive meaning; B has the right participle but dangles: it says the sender was damaged.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (5.1)

Dangling participles, especially with *-ing* + a non-human subject ("Walking home, the rain started") and *after* / *while* + *-ing* ("After finishing, the results...") · *-ing* for passive ("Building in 1968, the center...") · *having* for simultaneous actions ("Having walked home, I met a friend") · absolutes without a subject ("Being fine, we set off") or in L1 order ("Finished the meeting, we left") · over-compression: three participles in one sentence with the logic lost · full absolutes in casual messages. Correct dangles and voice errors every time (they change or garble the meaning); treat stiffness and over-compression as **Fit** or **Upgrade** comments, not errors.

5.2 · ADVANCED PREPOSITIONS & PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES (C15)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – HR VOICEMAIL (SCRIPT 5.2-A)

1	2	3	4
on behalf of	With regard to	In light of	comply with
5	6	7	8

refrain from	In the event of	consists of	increase in
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Accept *In the light of* (British). **Not accepted:** "with regards to," "refrain to," "consist in."

◆ EXERCISE 2 – SUPPLY THE PREPOSITION

- 1 comply **with**
- 2 reliant **on** (also *upon*, more formal)
- 3 account **for** (= explain)
- 4 conducive **to**
- 5 discuss – the proposal (transitive: no preposition)
- 6 objected **to** paying (*to* is a preposition here, so *paying*)
- 7 consistent **with**
- 8 resort **to** taking

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FIXED FORMAL PHRASES

- 1 **With regard to** your inquiry... (also: *Regarding*)
- 2 **In the event of** a power outage...
- 3 **On behalf of** the whole team...
- 4 **In light of** the new safety data... (new information → revision)
- 5 ...chair **by virtue of** her long experience...
- 6 **In the wake of** the merger...

Text to a friend: any two, e.g. 1 → "About your question, ..." · 2 → "If the power goes out, ..." · 4 → "Because of the new safety data / Now that we've seen the safety data, ..." · 6 → "After the merger, ...". Note: *on behalf of* (3) is fine in a friendly thank-you speech; accept learners who argue it isn't stiff.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – IN OR OF?

- 1 an increase **in** energy prices (area)
- 2 an increase **of** 12% (figure)
- 3 a decline **in** membership **of** about 300 people
- 4 a reduction **in** waiting times
- 5 a rise **of** two degrees

- 6 a fall **in** unemployment

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE CLINIC EMAIL (6 ERRORS)

- 1 With ~~regards~~ **regard** to your recent inquiry (or **Regarding**)
- 2 In accordance ~~to~~ **with** new county guidelines
- 3 aware ~~about~~ **of** the difficulties
- 4 an alternative ~~for~~ **to** the online system
- 5 refrain ~~to call~~ **from calling** the front desk
- 6 discuss ~~about~~ this further → **discuss this** further

Correct, leave alone: *result in shorter waiting times* (the change causes them). Learners who change it to *result from* reverse the meaning.

◆ DIALOGUE TASK

Chunks: *account for, results from, consistent with, indicative of, reliant on, an alternative to, an impact on*. Fixed phrases: *With regard to, In the event of, in accordance with*. In a hallway chat: "With regard to the quarterly figures" → "About the quarterly figures" (or "In the event of" → "If there's...").

◆ WORKSHOP – FORMAL EMAIL CORRECTION CHALLENGE (SET C)

Line	Error	Correction
1	With regard of	With regard to (or Regarding)
2	In light with	In light of
3	comply to	comply with
3	refrain to park	refrain from parking
4	subject for towing	subject to towing
5	a reduction of available parking	a reduction in available parking (area)
6	aware about	aware of
7	an alternative for	an alternative to
9	discussed about several options	discussed several options
10	by virtue to	by virtue of
10	consistent to	consistent with
11	On behalf for	On behalf of

The 5 decoys (correct; -1 if changed): line 5 *result in* (the work causes the reduction) · line 5 *of about 120 spaces* (of for the size of the change) · line 6 *reliant on* · line 8 *In the event of further delays* · line 10 *agreed to the shuttle proposal* (agree to a proposal). **Maximum score: 12.** Also accept, without penalty: *Regarding* for line 1; *in view of / because of* for line 2 (a meaning-preserving fix of the phrase).

◆ WORKSHOP, ROUND 2 – MODEL REPLIES

Card A (81 words, body): *Dear Ms. Whitfield, On behalf of the Evening Students' Council, thank you for your notice and for arranging the free shuttle. With regard to the shuttle schedule, many students are reliant on it between 5:30 and 6:30 p.m., so we would be grateful for a bus every ten minutes during that period. We are also concerned about lighting at the Oak Street garage, as some classes end at 9:30 p.m. Finally, in light of the reduction in parking, could March permits be partly refunded? Sincerely, ...*

Card B (84 words, body): *Dear Alex Rivera, Thank you for your message, and please accept our apologies for the short notice. The change resulted from the heavy rain earlier this month. In accordance with college policy, notices are normally sent seven days in advance, and we are fully aware of how disruptive a late notice can be. In light of this, we are offering a 50% reduction in the March permit fee. As an alternative to the north lot, a free shuttle runs from the Oak Street garage every twenty minutes. Sincerely, Facilities Office*

Mark for: four or more correct chunks, two fixed phrases used appropriately, a courteous formal tone, and no stacked formality ("In light of the fact that, with regard to the matter of...").

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

Which sentence uses the dependent preposition correctly?

A) We were not aware about the deadline.

B) Let's discuss about the results.

C) All staff must comply with the dress code.

Why: *comply* takes *with*. A should be *aware of*; B should be *discuss the results* (transitive, no preposition).

Q2

"There was a significant increase ____ carbon emissions."

A) of

B) on

C) in

Why: *in* introduces the area that changed. *Of* is for the size of the change (*an increase of 8%*); *on* doesn't follow *increase*.

Q3 · new

Which sentence is correct for a formal report?

A) In light of the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

B) In light with the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

C) By light of the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

Why: the fixed phrase is *in light of* (British: *in the light of*), used when new information prompts a change. B and C mangle the phrase.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (5.2)

"comply to" · "aware about" · "depend of" · "married with" · "discuss about / enter into the room / contact with" · "an increase of crime" · "capable to do / refrain to do / object to do" · "an alternative for" · "a solution of" · "with regards to" · "in the event that of..." · formal phrases stacked in one sentence, or used in casual speech ("In the event of you being free, ..."). Correct wrong chunks every time in writing (they're the whole point of the lesson); in speech, note them for feedback. Treat an unnecessary formal phrase as a **Fit** comment, not an error.

5.3 · ACADEMIC & FORMAL VOCABULARY (C16)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE RADIO ITEM (SCRIPT 5.3-A): ANY SIX

Casual	Academic
looked at	examined / studied / investigated
about sixty	approximately sixty
found out	found / determined / established
way more / a lot more focused	considerably / substantially more focused
went down a bit	decreased / declined slightly (modestly)
not enough to really prove anything	not statistically significant
kind of shows	suggests / indicates
might help	may be beneficial / may improve concentration
do a bigger study	conduct a larger study

◆ EXERCISE 2 – REPLACE THE INFORMAL WORD

- 1 obtain (or acquire, secure)
- 2 demonstrates (or illustrates)
- 3 substantial (or significant, considerable)
- 4 examine (or investigate, analyze)
- 5 sufficient (or adequate)
- 6 commence (or begin; *begin* is also perfectly formal)
- 7 approximately
- 8 deteriorate

Wrong: 3 "a significative rise" (Romance false form) · 7 "roughly" is correct but not academic: accept with a note · 2 "proves" over-claims for a graph.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WORD FAMILIES

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
analysis (analyst)	analyze	analytical	analytically
significance	signify	significant	significantly
evidence	—	evident	evidently
establishment	establish	established	—
consequence	—	consequent	consequently

a. **analysis** · b. **significantly** · c. **evident** · d. **consequently** (also *as a consequence*). Accept *evidence* as a verb ("as evidenced by") only if a learner raises it: it exists but is formal and mostly passive.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – STANCE AT THE RIGHT STRENGTH

- 1 **suggest** (the authors say "may": tentative)
- 2 **highlights** (draws attention to)
- 3 **acknowledge** (admits a limitation)
- 4 **demonstrates** (strong, consistent evidence justifies it)
- 5 **notes** (a neutral fact, not a contested position)
- 6 **maintain** (hold a position firmly, despite evidence)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SHARPER OR JUST FORMAL?

- 1 **Sharper** → "The team investigated the causes of the delay." (*investigated* is more exact and fits a report)
- 2 **Just formal** → "I'll use the conference room at three." (*utilize* adds length, not meaning)
- 3 **Just formal** (absurdly so) → "I'll try to leave soon." / "I'm heading off soon."
- 4 **Sharper** → "A substantial proportion of respondents were deterred by the price." (precise and appropriate to a research summary)

Labels are judgments: accept a different label if the learner's reason is sound (e.g. 1 "just formal" if they argue *looked into* is clear enough in an internal report).

◆ DIALOGUE TASK

looked at → an examination of · found out → indicated · a lot of people → a substantial proportion of respondents · got put off → were deterred · went up → increased · cut → reduced · kind of shows → suggests · the big thing → the primary factor · start doing across the board → implement more widely. The hedge: **suggests** (also *would ... be advisable*).

◆ WORKSHOP – MODEL SUMMARIES (FOR THE TEACHER, NOT A TARGET TO COPY)

Abstract 1 (87 words): *A recent pilot study examined the effect of short afternoon walking breaks on the concentration of 62 municipal office workers. Over four weeks, employees who took three five-minute walks each afternoon reported approximately 18% higher concentration than a control group; their accuracy on a data-entry task also improved slightly, although this difference was not statistically significant. The authors suggest that walking breaks may offer a low-cost means of sustaining concentration, but acknowledge that the small sample and reliance on self-report limit the findings. Larger studies are needed.*

Abstract 2 (86 words): *A twelve-week study in three university cafés evaluated a \$1 deposit scheme for reusable cups. Disposable cup use fell by approximately 41%, although total café waste declined by only 6%, partly owing to an increase in food packaging. Staff reported that the scheme was easy to administer, but returns decreased toward the end of the semester. The authors conclude that such schemes can substantially reduce disposable cup use, yet their effect on overall waste appears modest; longer-term research is needed to determine whether participation is sustained.*

Fidelity checks: Abstract 1: the accuracy result must be qualified (*not statistically significant* / *did not reach significance*); "improved concentration" should be *self-reported* or *reported*; no *prove* / *demonstrate* / *show that walking breaks work*. Abstract 2: don't say the scheme "reduced waste substantially" (only cup use fell substantially).

Word-family shift examples: *significant* → *significance* ("did not reach significance"), *analyze* → *analysis*, *generalize* → *generalizability*, *concentrate* → *concentration*.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

In an academic essay, which is the best upgrade of "The results show the plan didn't really work"?

A) The results demonstrate that the plan was largely ineffective.

B) The results kind of show the plan didn't work out.

C) The results evidence that the plan's utilization was suboptimal.

Why: precise academic words, natural structure. B stays casual; C is over-formalized and garbled (*evidence* as a verb, empty *utilization*).

Q2

A friend texts to ask when you're leaving. Which reply has the right register?

A) I shall commence my departure imminently.

B) I'll head off in about ten minutes.

C) I anticipate initiating my egress shortly.

Why: plain, friendly words suit a text to a friend. A and C are grammatical but absurdly formal: an error of register.

Q3 · new

An abstract says brief walking breaks "may" improve concentration. Which summary sentence is faithful?

A) The findings prove that brief walking breaks improve concentration.

B) The findings suggest that brief walking breaks may improve concentration.

C) The findings indicate walking breaks is the primary factor of concentration.

Why: B keeps the source's tentative stance. A over-claims (*prove*); C over-claims (*the primary factor*) and has an agreement error (*breaks is*) and a preposition slip (*factor in*).

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (5.3)

Over-claiming a source ("This study proves...") · wrong-sense upgrades ("a significant building" for a big one, "approximately the budget" for "regarding") · empty formality (*utilize, commence, endeavor, in order to* everywhere) · Romance false friends (*actual* for current, *realize a study, assist* for attend, *significant*) · word-family slips ("an analyze," "significance improved," "evidently" for "evident") · stress errors on *analysis, significant, approximately, deteriorate* · copying whole abstract sentences instead of summarizing. Correct over-claiming and wrong-sense words every time (they misinform); treat stiffness as a **Fit** comment.

◆ THE EDITOR'S PATH – BOARD ANSWERS (SET E)

2 Having read the email, he called the client. · 3 with · 4 Driving to work, I found the traffic terrible. / As I was driving to work, the traffic was terrible. · 5 investigate / examine · 6 of · 7 The work finished (done / over), we went home. · 8 If it rains, we'll eat inside. · 9 **analysis** · 10 any correct phrase in a sentence (*having said that, all things considered, weather permitting, given that...*) · 11 suggest · 12 to · 13 Written · 14 none: discuss the plan · 15 sufficient / adequate · 16 virtue of · 17 Items damaged in transit will be replaced. · 18 I'll use a pen. · 19 from · 20 acknowledge / concede · 21 sound (fixed phrase) · 22 deteriorate · 23 of · FINISH: e.g. "Having examined the data, the team found a substantial increase in demand."

Module 6 — Reading & Writing at C1: Answers

Answers to every Module 6 workbook exercise and self-check question, a full analysis of the two Harborview articles (with the company's real pilot figures), model answers for the open writing tasks, notes on using the five genre rubrics, and the errors you can expect to see most.

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

9 self-check items

15 exercises

5 rubrics

MARKING PRINCIPLE

This module is about **reasoning and genre**, so many answers are open. Accept any analysis that is **accurate, anchored in the text and precisely named**. A learner who calls sentence A14 a "false dilemma" and another who calls it "an appeal to fear" can both be right if they can say why. What you do not accept: vague labels with no textual anchor ("it's biased"), and verdicts about the *topic* (whether the four-day week is good) offered in place of verdicts about the *argument*. For writing, mark with the rubrics in the workbook: four criteria, three bands each, 12 points per genre. American spelling and conventions are the model (*organization, analyze, Ms., Sincerely, résumé, inquire*); accept British forms (*organisation, Yours sincerely, CV, enquire*) when used consistently. At C1, **appropriacy counts as much as accuracy**: a grammatically perfect email that buries its request is not a strong email.

6.1 • CRITICAL READING — EVALUATING ARGUMENTS & BIAS (C17)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE RADIO COMMENTARY (SCRIPT 6.1-A)

- 1 **Claim:** supermarkets (in Riverside) should get rid of their self-checkout machines.
- 2 **Evidence 1:** the 81-year-old neighbor who struggled for twenty minutes: an **anecdote** (one case, presented as typical).
- 3 **Evidence 2:** theft rose by 20 percent at one store on Pine Street, according to its manager: **statistics + testimony**, but from a single store (unrepresentative / possibly cherry-picked), and the rise may have other causes (false cause).
- 4 **Weakness:** the **false dilemma** at the end ("either we keep real cashiers, or... nobody talks to anybody"). Also accept: **bandwagon** ("what everybody is already thinking"), **concede and dismiss** (shorter lines, waved away), **appeal to emotion** / rhetorical question ("Is that the kind of town we want...?"), loaded language ("fighting with", "ruining").
- 5 **Tone:** indignant • exasperated • nostalgic • combative. Accept any precise adjective; do not accept "negative" or "angry" without refinement at C1. Push: "Angry how? Contemptuous? Wistful?"

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FACT, OPINION, OR OPINION IN DISGUISE?

1 **F** · 2 **F** · 3 **D** (*clearly* presents a judgment as self-evident) · 4 **F** (checkable; whether it is *significant* is another matter) · 5 **D** (*It is widely accepted* borrows the authority of consensus without evidence) · 6 **F** · 7 **D** (a causal claim stated as fact; it can be investigated, but here it is asserted) · 8 **O** (*Frankly* openly signals a personal judgment).

Item 7 generates the best discussion. Some learners will say "F, because you could check it." Good: a causal claim is *testable in principle*, but the sentence offers no test. That is exactly the gap a critical reader notices. Accept **D** or a well-argued **O**; do not accept **F** without that nuance.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – VERBS FOR WHAT A WRITER DOES

1 **C** (assert) · 2 **E** (concede) · 3 **H** (downplay) · 4 **F** (imply) · 5 **D** (refute) · 6 **B** (overstate) · 7 **G** (dismiss) · 8 **A** (concede ... but downplay)

Watch: *refute* means to *prove* wrong; in everyday use people say "he refuted the claim" when he only denied it. At C1, prefer *rebut* or *reject* for an attempt, *refute* for a successful one. Also: *imply* (the writer hints) vs *infer* (the reader concludes).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MAP THE TWO ARGUMENTS

	Article A (Whitfield)	Article B (Keane)
Central claim	A17 (also A2): Harborview should make the four-day week permanent.	B17 (also B4): management should end the experiment.
Purpose · stance · tone	persuade · strongly for · enthusiastic, impatient, campaigning; contemptuous of opponents	persuade · strongly against · scornful, alarmed, dismissive
Strongest evidence	A3 statistics (sick days –18%) or A10 expert testimony (rested staff make fewer errors): relevant, but see weaknesses	B3 statistics (complaints +11%): relevant to customers, the company's core business
Weakest evidence	A4 (best month only: cherry-picking) · A6–9 (one anecdote + "stories like hers are everywhere": generalization) · A13 (popularity as proof: bandwagon)	B5–8 (one bakery: anecdote + appeal to emotion) · B11 (profits fell → caused by pilot: false cause) · B12 (expert gives an opinion about <i>tech</i> companies, not data about logistics)
Concession	A11 (response times slipped) → downplayed in A12 ("minor teething problem," "will surely disappear": assertion, no evidence)	B13 (turnover fell) → dismissed in B14 with an unsupported generalization about "young workers"
Loaded phrases	"unthinkable" · "dinosaurs in the boardroom" · "drag" · "grinding five-day treadmill" · "forward-thinking" · "merely present"	"pleasant holiday" · "fashionable gimmick" · "gives in" · "struggling to survive" · "run on goodwill alone"

A hidden warrant	A3→A17: the four-day week (not the season) caused the fall in sick days. · A10→A17: Harborview staff are now more rested, and therefore make fewer errors. · A13→A17: what many companies do is right for Harborview.	B3→B17: the complaints were caused by the pilot and will continue. · B11→B17: the pilot, not other costs, caused the profit fall. · B12→B17: a consultant's general opinion applies to this company.
Fallacies	A4 cherry-picking · A5 straw man (opponents don't claim that "more hours automatically mean more work") · A9 unsupported generalization · A13 bandwagon · A14 false dilemma · A15 attacking the person ("dinosaurs") + false dilemma in the rhetorical question · A16 bare assertion ("The answer is obvious")	B4 overstatement ("alone should end the discussion") · B7–8 appeal to emotion · B9 straw man (supporters argue for the same output in fewer hours, not "paid for doing less") · B11 false cause · B14 unsupported generalization · B15–16 slippery slope

THE REAL PILOT FIGURES (EVIDENCE CHECKER ROLE CARD · CLASSROOM MATERIALS, SET C)

The Evidence Checker holds these invented "official" figures. They reveal that **both** columnists select and frame the data:

- ◆ **Sick days:** –18% compared with the *previous six months* (July–December, which includes the winter flu season); only –7% compared with the same months last year. Whitfield's figure is real but flattering: a **false cause** risk (season) and an unstated comparison.
- ◆ **Output:** +9% per employee in May (the best month); –2% averaged over the six months; **output per hour worked** +8%. Whitfield cherry-picks May; Keane ignores the per-hour gain.
- ◆ **Customer complaints:** +11% over six months overall, but +31% in January–February; back to normal by April; –3% in May–June compared with last year. Keane's total hides a problem that had already **faded**; Whitfield's "teething problem" is closer to the truth, but she asserts it without showing it.
- ◆ **Profits:** Q1 +1%; Q2 –4%. Industry fuel costs rose 15% in Q2, and competitors' profits fell by about 5%. Keane's **false cause**.
- ◆ **Staff turnover:** 6 people left during the pilot, compared with 14 in the same months last year. **Staff survey:** 81% want to continue; 12% say the workload is harder to manage in four days.

A strong group verdict: "*Whitfield makes the stronger case, because the full figures mostly support her, but neither article is well argued: both select data and substitute loaded language for evidence.*" Also accept a well-reasoned verdict for Keane (e.g. the early complaint spike is a real business risk).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – TAKE THE LOADING OUT

- 1 senior managers who oppose the change · *smuggled in:* they are outdated and doomed
- 2 this new scheduling policy / this trial · *smuggled in:* it is trivial and a passing trend
- 3 return staff to a five-day week · *smuggled in:* force, suffering, pointless repetition

- 4 a shorter working week for employees · *smuggled in*: staff are relaxing, not working
- 5 management reduced customer service hours / staffing · *smuggled in*: violence, carelessness, blame
- 6 experts who disagree · *smuggled in*: their expertise is fake (innuendo)

Accept any genuinely neutral wording. Reject "euphemistic" rewrites that load the other way ("a well-earned rest," "streamlined service"); that is the stretch discussion.

◆ DIALOGUE – TALKING ABOUT A TEXT

Evaluative verbs: *asserts* · *concedes* · *downplays* · *dismisses* (also *convince*, *recruiting*, *informing* as describing moves). Tomás's verdict: "Where it should be: with the full figures, not with either columnist." (Also accept "Neither of them is arguing in good faith.")

◆ MODEL CRITICAL EVALUATION · RUBRIC NOTES

The model in the workbook (on Article B) would score **12/12**. Homework asks learners to write their own on **Article A** or an article of their choice. A 12/12 answer on Article A names: the claim (A17); purpose/tone with a quotation ("dinosaurs in the boardroom"); the sick-day figure as relevant but uncomparing; the May figure as cherry-picked; the concession in A11 downplayed in A12; the false dilemma in A14; a fair, hedged verdict. Typical **6–8/12**: accurate on loaded language, but "evaluates" evidence only by repeating it, and ends "I agree with her."

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"Since the ban came in, accidents have fallen, so the ban clearly works." What should a critical reader most suspect?

A) That the accident figures must have been invented

B) That the sentence uses loaded language

C) A false cause: the ban preceding the fall does not prove it caused it

Why: sequence is not causation. Other factors (weather, road works, fewer drivers) may explain the fall. A is cynicism, not critical reading; B misreads a mostly neutral sentence (*clearly* is the only loaded word).

Q2

"The council's reckless plan will devastate our neighborhood." What does the word choice tell a critical reader?

A) The language is loaded: it signals the writer's stance before any evidence is given

B) The plan is definitely dangerous, because the writer says so

C) The sentence is neutral and factual

Why: *reckless* and *devastate* carry the judgment. Loaded language is a flag to check the evidence, not proof that the writer is wrong (and not proof that they are right: B).

Q3 · new

"Remote workers answer emails faster, so remote work makes people more productive." Which is the unstated warrant?

A) Remote workers receive more emails than office workers.

B) Answering emails quickly is a good measure of overall productivity.

C) Some people prefer working in an office.

Why: the argument only works if email speed stands for productivity, which is exactly where it can be challenged (fast replies may mean constant interruption). A is a new fact, not the linking assumption; C is irrelevant.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (6.1)

"There are many evidences." (uncountable: *a great deal of evidence*, *several pieces of evidence*) · "The author says that..." everywhere (push for *contends*, *asserts*, *concedes*) · "This is a fallacy" with no name or anchor · confusing *imply* and *infer* · "The writer criticizes the council" (*criticizes*; *critic* is a person, *critique* a noun/formal verb) · "In my opinion the article is bad" (a reaction, not an evaluation) · false friends: *actual* for "current" (Spanish/Portuguese/French), *argument* for "plot" or "topic" (Spanish *argumento*, Italian *argomento*) · treating every emotional word as a fallacy. For range, praise *the evidence is suggestive but not conclusive* · *conflates correlation with cause* · *the figure is conspicuously absent* · *to her credit, she concedes...*

6.2 · ACADEMIC & ARGUMENT WRITING — STRUCTURING AN ESSAY (C18)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE INTRODUCTION (SCRIPT 6.2-A)

- 1 **Hook:** an observation / striking fact: in the center of many mid-sized American cities, one of the most common land uses is parking. (Accept "a surprising observation," "a vivid scene.")

- 2 **Context:** lots are half-empty much of the week, but councils are reluctant to remove them, fearing fewer shoppers.
- 3 **Thesis:** "Although drivers' needs cannot simply be ignored, converting underused lots into public squares would bring more people downtown, not fewer, and would give struggling town centers a reason to exist beyond the car." (Accept close paraphrase that keeps the concession and both reasons.)
- 4 **Predicted body paragraphs:** (1) foot traffic / business for shops; (2) community life / a reason to visit downtown; (3) counter-argument: drivers, access, disabled parking, rebutted.
- 5 **Although** (the concession: drivers' needs).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THESIS CLINIC

1 T · 2 O · 3 F · 4 Q (salaries, not training time) · 5 S

Model rewrites: (1/2) "Employers should give staff paid time for training, because a workforce that keeps learning adapts faster to new technology and is less likely to leave." · (3) "While paid training time is costly for small businesses, the case for it is stronger than the case against: the cost of skills gaps and staff turnover is higher still." · (4) "Paid training time is a better investment for employers than across-the-board pay raises, because it increases both productivity and retention." Accept the opposite position if it is specific and arguable ("Paid training time should be optional, not required, because...").

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SIGNPOSTING THAT MATCHES THE LOGIC

1 **Consequently** (result) · 2 **By contrast** (two things compared) · 3 **Nevertheless** (concession, then a turn) · 4 **Furthermore** (another point on the same side) · 5 **Admittedly** (opens a concession) · 6 **For instance** (example)

7 "...saved the company money. **Nevertheless** / **However** / **Even so**, some staff disliked it." Disliking it is not a *result* of saving money; it is a contrast.

Item 2 vs 3 is the key C1 distinction: *By contrast* compares two different things; *Nevertheless* accepts a point and then turns against its expected consequence. *However* would fit both, which is why it is overused.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CONCEDE AND REBUT, FAIRLY

The straw man is **B**, because nobody opposing paid training argues that workers "should never learn anything new"; the real objection is cost (as in A). B also rebuts with a truism ("the world is changing"), not a reason.

Model (phones collected: for): "Admittedly, collecting phones may seem to treat adults like schoolchildren, and some staff need to remain reachable for urgent calls. Yet this overlooks the fact that a short, device-free meeting respects everyone's time more than a longer, distracted one, and a single designated contact can handle genuine emergencies." (**against**): "Admittedly, phones on the table can distract a meeting. However, this overlooks the fact that many staff use their phones for the agenda, notes and calendars; a clear norm (screens face-down unless needed) addresses the distraction without removing the tools."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – REBUILD A PEEL PARAGRAPH

B (Point) → D (Evidence) → A (Explanation) → C (Link)

Clues: B is the only sentence that works without context (topic sentence; *also* links to a previous paragraph); D has *for instance*; A has *This suggests* (referencing back to the evidence); C has *It follows that* and widens to the thesis.

◆ DIALOGUE – A PEER REVIEW

Softening phrases: *I wasn't entirely sure how...* · *You might consider adding...* · *I'd question the rebuttal* · *That reads a little like...* (also *it's fair, but*). She checks the thesis first so that all her feedback is measured against what the writer is *trying* to do, and so the writer knows the main message has landed.

◆ WORKSHOP – OUTLINE, DRAFT, PEER REVIEW

Model theses for every question card are printed on the teacher strip under the cards (classroom materials, set E). Mark the draft (introduction + one paragraph) against the first three rubric rows only; save the full rubric for the finished essay (homework). Check the peer-review sheets as well as the drafts: a reviewer who ticks every box "Y" and writes "good" in both boxes has not reviewed. Return those with one question: "Which sentence would you cut?"

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which of these is the strongest thesis statement for an argument essay?

A) "This essay will discuss electric cars and their advantages and disadvantages."

B) "Although electric cars are costly upfront, their long-term savings and lower emissions make them the better choice for most drivers."

C) "Electric cars are a type of vehicle that runs on electricity."

Why: B concedes, commits and previews two reasons; a reasonable person could disagree. A announces a topic; C is a definition.

Q2

You are writing your conclusion and think of a strong new piece of evidence. What should you do?

A) Move it into a body paragraph, where it can be developed; the conclusion introduces no new points

B) Add it to the conclusion for a strong finish

C) Leave it out entirely, since the essay is nearly done

Why: new material in a conclusion leaves a loose thread. Good evidence is worth the revision (C wastes it).

Q3 • new

"Critics argue that paid training is expensive." Which is the strongest rebuttal?

A) "But these critics clearly don't care about workers."

B) "Yet the cost of replacing staff who leave for lack of development is often far higher."

C) "However, training is very important."

Why: B answers the actual objection (cost) with a comparison of costs. A attacks the critics, not the argument; C is a truism that ignores the objection.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (6.2)

Thesis as announcement ("In this essay I will talk about...") · the thesis in the first sentence, with no hook or context · "On the other hand" used to add a point (it must contrast, ideally after *On the one hand*) · "Besides," / "Moreover," / "Furthermore," opening every sentence · comma splices ("Remote work saves time, it also reduces costs.") · evidence dropped without explanation · *In conclusion* + a new argument · informal slips (*a lot of, stuff, nowadays everybody*) · overgeneralizing (*always, everyone, never*) where a hedge is needed (*often, many, tends to*) · "Some people say... but I think..." as the entire counter-argument. For range, praise *Granted, ... · This objection rests on the assumption that... · Far from..., ... · It is precisely... that...* (cleft from Module 2).

6.3 • PROFESSIONAL & FORMAL WRITING — REPORTS, EMAILS & APPLICATIONS (C19)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — FROM VOICEMAIL TO EMAIL (SCRIPT 6.3-A)

Notes: To: the four Receiving team leaders (Dev, Maria, Olu, Chris) · Purpose: tell them the digital shift-swap trial starts Monday, March 3, in Receiving only · Action: each sends the names of two volunteers by noon Thursday; confirm attendance at training · Details: training this Wednesday, 2:00–3:00 p.m., Conference Room B; copy (cc) Karen Liu.

READ ALOUD

Subject: Shift-swap app trial starts March 3 — two volunteers needed by Thursday noon

Hi Dev, Maria, Olu and Chris,

I am writing on Karen Liu's behalf to let you know that the new digital shift-swap trial will begin in Receiving on Monday, March 3.

Could you each please send me the names of two volunteers to test the app by noon this Thursday? There will also be a short training session for team leaders this Wednesday from 2:00 to 3:00 p.m. in Conference Room B; I would be grateful if you could confirm that you can attend.

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Best regards,

[Name]

cc: Karen Liu

Accept *Dear all*, or *Hello everyone*; *Hi* + names is normal among colleagues. The deadline, the date and cc Karen are the details most often lost. A subject line of "Trial" or "Info" scores 1 on the first rubric row.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THE RIGHT FORMULA

1 I am writing to inquire · 2 Please find attached · 3 Following up on our conversation · 4 I would be grateful if you could · 5 please do not hesitate to contact me · 6 I look forward to hearing from you

Accept *enquire* (British). In 1, *about* must follow *inquire*; learners who write "I am writing to ask" have the right register with a less formal verb: *accept*. In 5, lowercase *please* after the comma.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – REGISTER REPAIR

- 1 **Problem:** far too informal for the reader (and vague: "sort it"). **Model:** "Dear Mr. Alvarez, I am writing about the quarterly safety report, which is due on Friday, May 16. Could you please confirm who will be completing it this quarter? Thank you. Best regards, ..."
- 2 **Problem:** buried purpose; filler. **Model:** "Dear Ms. Adeyemi, I am writing because we have not yet received the invoice for March. Could you please send it by Friday? Thank you. Kind regards, ..."
- 3 **Problem:** over-softened; no specific date. **Model:** "I would like to request a day off on Friday, May 23. Please let me know whether this can be approved."
- 4 **Problem:** archaic, absurdly stiff for a colleague. **Model:** "Hi Sara, could we find twenty minutes this week to go over the proposal? I'd really value your input."

Accept any version that leads with the purpose, keeps the request clear, and matches the reader. Invented names and dates are fine; missing dates are not.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – NOTES INTO REPORT LANGUAGE

- 1 A survey was distributed to all staff.
- 2 A majority of respondents described the form as difficult to complete. (Also: *The majority of respondents reported difficulty completing the form.*)
- 3 Approval was found to take an average of four days. / Swaps were found to take four days, on average, to approve.
- 4 It is recommended that the paper form be replaced / discontinued. (Accept *should be replaced*; point out the subjunctive *be* as the more formal choice, from Lesson 1.3.)
- 5 Inconsistent approval across teams was a significant source of dissatisfaction. / Dissatisfaction arose from inconsistent approval across teams.

Wrong: "It is recommended that the form is replaced" (acceptable in British English; in American formal writing prefer *be*) · "It is recommended to replace..." (acceptable but less formal) · keeping "we" and "loads of" · "Majority of respondents" (needs *A* or *The*).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CONFIDENT, NOT BOASTFUL

1 B · 2 C · 3 H · 4 C · 5 B · 6 H

Model rewrites. B → C: "I have presented our team's monthly results to senior management for two years and led the orientation for every new hire." H → C: "Although I am new to this sector, I bring three years of scheduling experience and a certificate in logistics, which I completed while working full-time." For item 6, the best advice is to **delete the apology**: never draw a reader's attention to your English; let the letter demonstrate it.

◆ WRITING LAB – MODEL REPORT SECTIONS (DATA CARD, CLASSROOM MATERIALS SET 6)

The data card (*Harborview break-room and canteen survey*) is deliberately different from the workbook model so that learners cannot copy it. A 12/12 answer: **3. Findings** with three subheadings (e.g. *Opening hours* · *Food options* · *Seating*), each reporting the key figure neutrally ("Almost two thirds of night-shift respondents (64%) reported that no hot food was available during their break."); **4. Conclusions** hedged ("These findings suggest that night-shift staff are poorly served..."); **5. Recommendations** specific and justified ("It is recommended that a vending option for hot meals be installed...; that 20 additional seats be provided..."). Deduct on Use of data if the writer invents figures or reports only the most dramatic ones.

◆ WRITING LAB – COVER LETTERS: WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The strongest letters quote or mirror two or three phrases from the job posting and answer each with evidence. The commonest weakness at C1 is not grammar but **generic content**: a letter that could be sent to any employer. Ask "Which sentence could only be written to *this* employer?" Learners writing from profile cards should still target the posting; those writing as themselves may invent details they would rather not share. In the United States, a cover letter does **not** include age, marital status, nationality, religion or a photo; if learners add these (common in some countries' conventions), explain the convention; don't mark it as a language error.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

You need a colleague to send figures by Friday. Which request is best for professional writing?

A) "I was just wondering if maybe it might be possible to perhaps get some figures sometime?"

B) "Send me the figures by Friday."

C) "I would be grateful if you could send the figures by Friday."

Why: polite framing (*I would be grateful if*) plus a clear request and deadline. A is over-softened and vague; B is clear but curt for most workplace relationships.

Q2

Which sentence strikes the right confident-but-not-boastful tone for a cover letter?

A) "I am an exceptional leader with unrivaled talent and natural brilliance."

B) "I led a team of four and delivered the project two weeks ahead of schedule."

C) "I don't really have much experience, but I hope I might just about be suitable."

Why: B lets a specific, verifiable achievement speak. A is empty self-praise; C undersells and plants doubt.

Q3 · new

You are writing to a hiring manager, Ms. Carter, for the first time. Which opening and closing suit American business English best?

A) "Hi Ms. Carter!" ... "Cheers,"

B) "Dear Ms. Carter," ... "Sincerely,"

C) "Dear Sir or Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

Why: you know her name, so use it, with the formal American pair. A is too casual for a first contact. C is the British convention for an *unknown* reader; in American English, *Dear Hiring Manager*, is now the usual choice when the name is unknown.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (6.3)

"Dear Sir/Madam" when the name is on the posting · "Dear Mrs. Carter" (use *Ms.* unless you know her preference) · "Dear Karen Liu" (full name in the greeting) · missing subject line or "Hello" as subject · "I am writing you to..." (acceptable in informal American English; prefer *I am writing to* in formal text) · "Please find attached my CV" with no attachment · "Kindly do the needful" / "Please revert back" (regional usage in South Asian English: explain that US readers may not understand it) · "Respected Sir" · "Hope you are fine" (*well*) · "I am interesting in this position" (*interested*) · "informations," "advices," "equipments" · date ambiguity (03/04) · reports that mix opinion into findings ("Sadly, 58% of staff...") · "It is recommended that the form is replaced" (accept, but teach *be*). For range, praise *In light of these findings...* · *a marked decline in...* · *I would welcome the opportunity to...* and a well-judged register switch between the email and the report.

Module 7 — Listening, Speaking & Delivery: Answers

Answers to every Module 7 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model notes and a model summary for the Listening Lab, model rewrites and paraphrases for the discussion tasks, and the errors you can expect to hear most.

Lessons 7.1-7.3

Classes C20-C22

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

These are skills lessons, so many answers are **judgments**, not single words. Accept any answer that shows the skill: notes that capture the three points in a hierarchy, however they are abbreviated; a chunking that puts pauses at meaning boundaries, even if it differs slightly from the key; a respectful rewrite that acknowledges, softens and still challenges. Mark **range, accuracy and appropriacy**. An answer can be grammatically perfect and still inappropriate (a "paraphrase" that twists the speaker's point, an acknowledgment so generic it sounds sarcastic). Notes may use the learner's first language or their own symbols. American English is the model; British spellings (*summarise, centre, cancelled*) are fine when learners use them. Pronunciation answers describe **standard American** stress and intonation; other clear, consistent patterns are acceptable.

7.1 • UNDERSTANDING LECTURES & TALKS (C20)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — NAME THE FUNCTION

1 recap • 2 preview • 3 example • 4 digression • 5 sequence • 6 emphasis • 7 example • 8 recap

Accept "conclusion" for 1 and 8, "sequencing / moving on" for 5, "aside" for 4. In 8, *the upshot is* is a recap signpost even when it appears mid-talk: it announces a distilled conclusion.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — PREDICT WHAT COMES NEXT

- 1 "On the other hand...": a contrasting point, probably a cost or disadvantage of remote work.
- 2 A challenge to the assumption: "...but in fact / but the evidence suggests..." (for example, that older learners have real advantages).
- 3 Exactly two criticisms, probably signposted "The first... The second..."
- 4 The speaker will raise the objection and then answer it, probably arguing that a longer break does *not* lower productivity (or even raises it).
- 5 The speaker's own answer to the rhetorical question: a main idea about why it matters for commuters. Get ready to star it.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – MAIN IDEA, DETAIL OR ASIDE?

(a) **M** (flagged: "The central point I want to make") · (b) **D** (evidence: an experiment) · (c) **A** ("As an aside": skip it) · (d) **M** ("Crucially") · (e) **D** ("For instance": an example) · (f) **M** ("the upshot": the conclusion)

If learners mark (b) as M, ask the recap question: "Would the speaker repeat the finger-tapping experiment in her summary, or the claim it supports?"

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FROM SENTENCES TO NOTES

Part A: 1 **cities** · 2 **fall** (or ↓) · 3 **booming** (or ↑) · 4 **dispersed**. The recap sentence ("the office didn't disappear; it dispersed") compresses the whole talk: that's the line to keep.

Part B: model notes (any clear version is correct):

- 1 car-centered design → walking = chore → health ↓
- 2 car suburbs: walking ↓↓ vs downtown
- 3 ≠ laziness; = design ★
- 4 tools exist: wider sidewalks, mixed-use zoning, slow traffic

Wrong (in spirit): notes that keep *is*, *the*, *it* and read as a shorter sentence ("Car design is making walking a chore"). The test: could you write it while the speaker says the next sentence?

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE LISTENING LAB (SCRIPT 7.1-A)

Part A — model notes (the shape matters, not the exact words):

READ ALOUD

TALK: cramming = inefficient; 2 changes → big diff (thesis)

3 parts announced

1. forgetting

- Ebbinghaus, 1880s, tested himself
- (aside: nonsense syllables DAX, BOK – skip)
- > ½ lost in 1 day; then slower decline = "forgetting curve"
- ★ curve not fixed: each review → forget more slowly

2. spacing

- belief: more hrs = more memory (partly true) BUT when ≈ how long
- e.g. 3 hrs Sun night vs 1 hr M/W/F → spaced student wins, wk later
- spacing effect = v. reliable finding
- why? (hedged: "one explanation") some forgetting → effort to rebuild → stronger

3. testing yourself ★★ (most imp)

- test ≠ just measuring; = learning
- Roediger & Karpicke 2006: reread vs recall on blank page
- 5 min: rereaders slightly better; 1 wk: testers remember much more
- rereading feels productive (familiar) ≠ learning
- ★ "feeling of fluency ≠ learning"

RECAP: forget fast, review slows it · spacing > cramming · retrieval > rereading

∴ best learners: right intervals + test selves (not longest hours)

★ "close notes, see what you remember"

Cue column examples: *Thesis?* · *What is the forgetting curve?* · *What flattens it?* · *Spacing: claim vs example?* · *Why does spacing work (how sure)?* · *2006 study: 5 min vs 1 wk?* · *Why does rereading mislead?* · *Upshot?* **Summary strip** example: "Cramming fails because we forget fast; spacing study and testing yourself (not rereading) make memories last."

Part B — Comprehension

- 1 Cramming is one of the least efficient ways to learn, and two simple changes to how you study (spacing and testing yourself) make a remarkable difference.
- 2 (1) How quickly we forget · (2) why spacing out study works better than cramming · (3) why testing yourself beats rereading.
- 3 Within a day he had lost well over half of what he had learned; the decline then continued more slowly for weeks. Each time he reviewed, the curve flattened: he forgot more slowly the next time.
- 4 Both study for three hours in total: one does all three hours on Sunday night; the other does one hour on Monday, Wednesday and Friday. A week later, the second (spaced) student remembers more, often by a wide margin.
- 5 Some students reread a passage several times; others read it once and then tried to recall it on a blank page. After five minutes the rereaders did slightly better; after a week the students who had tested themselves remembered considerably more.
- 6 "Don't just review your notes: close them, and see what you can remember."

Part B — Inference

- 1 The third part, testing yourself. Evidence: "the part I care about most" (preview) and "the one I'd most like you to take away" (point 3); she also flags it with "I can't stress this enough." Accept either two.
- 2 It's a digression with a touch of humor and personal stance (the speaker finds the methods boring). It signals "don't worry about this." It does **not** belong in the notes, or at most as "(aside – skip)." It's framed by "As an aside" and "I won't dwell on his methods."
- 3 She **concedes** part of a common belief before overturning it (concession → counter-argument). After "that's true" a listener should expect "**But...**": here, "the research shows that when you study matters at least as much as how long."
- 4 (a) Very certain: "one of the **most reliable** findings in the whole of psychology" (a booster). (b) Tentative: "**One explanation** is that..." (a hedge: there may be others).
- 5 The ease of recognizing familiar material makes us **feel** we have learned it, but recognizing is not the same as being able to recall it later. Rereading makes the text look familiar, so we overestimate what we know; retrieval is harder, and the effort is what builds memory.

- 6 Probably: "Five rereads the night before will feel productive, but you'll forget most of it. Spread the review over several days and, instead of rereading, close the notes and test yourself." Accept any answer that includes spacing **and** retrieval, and mentions the illusion of fluency.

Part C — model summary (4 sentences):

The speaker argues that cramming is an inefficient way to learn and that two changes to how we study make a large difference. She explains that we forget quickly but that each review slows forgetting, and that spacing study over several sessions is more effective than cramming the same hours into one. Her central point is that testing yourself works better than rereading, because retrieving information strengthens memory while rereading only feels productive. She concludes that effective learners study at intervals and test themselves along the way.

Check against the peer-review list: the claim comes first; the three points are in order; no names (Ebbinghaus, Roediger), dates or the two-student example; the conclusion is the speaker's. **Common problems:** a summary that retells the examples in order ("First she talked about a German psychologist..."); a summary that adds the writer's opinion ("I think this is true because..."); "The lecture is about the cramming."

◆ DIALOGUE — AFTER THE LECTURE

Signposts quoted: *This talk falls into three parts* (preview) · *as an aside* and *I won't dwell on his methods* (digression) · *I can't stress this enough* (emphasis). Lena also uses *the upshot* (recap). Main idea vs example: Omar's line 6 ("That's just the example. The point is that *when* you study...") and line 8 ("The study's the evidence. The main idea is..."). Lena's "So the students are the packaging" echoes the lesson's image.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A speaker says, "As an aside, I won't dwell on the funding history." What does this signpost tell an advanced listener?

A) It's the most important point: capture every word.

B) It's a recap of what came before.

C) It's a digression: optional detail you can safely skip.

Why: *As an aside* and *I won't dwell on* are digression signals. The information won't come back; save your attention for the main thread.

Q2

What is the single most useful habit when taking notes on a fast lecture?

A) Write keywords in a hierarchy, not full sentences.

B) Try to transcribe every word the speaker says.

C) Write nothing until the recap, then note only that.

Why: keywords are fast and the hierarchy keeps the shape of the argument. Transcribing (B) falls behind and loses the structure; waiting for the recap (C) loses the support and the stance.

Q3 · new

A lecturer says, "Now, you might think a test is simply a way of measuring what you know." What is most likely to come next?

A) An example of a test the lecturer took.

B) The lecturer's answer to this view, probably showing that it's incomplete.

C) A recap of the whole talk.

Why: "Now, you might think..." raises an objection or a common belief so the speaker can answer it. In the lecture, the next line is "In fact, it's one of the best ways of learning."

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (7.1)

Notes in full sentences · notes that keep every example and lose the claim · treating the digression (nonsense syllables) as important · "The lecture is about the cramming." · "She suggests us to test ourself." (→ *suggests testing ourselves / suggests that we test ourselves*) · "The speaker said that we must to space..." · summaries that begin "In this lecture, first she talked about..." (a chronological retelling, not a summary) · summaries that end with the writer's opinion. Praise range: *concedes that... but argues..., the upshot is..., she hedges this claim.*

7.2 · PRONUNCIATION & INTONATION FOR FLUENCY (C21)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TAP THE BEATS

- 1 I'd LIKE to BOOK a TABLE for TWO at EIGHT. · weak: *to, a, for, at*
- 2 When the MEETing FINishes, / I'll SEND you the NOTES. · weak: *the, you* (also *I'll*)
- 3 The reSULTS were BETter than we exPECTed. · weak: *the, were /wə/, than /ðən/, we*
- 4 Could you SEND me a COpy of the rePORT? · weak: *could /kəd/, you /jə/, a, of, the*

- 5 We **NEED** to **FINish** the **proPOSal** by **FRIday**. · weak: *to, the* (*by* is unstressed but keeps its vowel)

Watch word stress inside the stressed words: *reSULTS*, *exPECTed*, *rePORT*, *proPOSal* (not "REsults," "PROposal"). Accept a light stress on *When* in 2 or *Could* in 4 in slow speech. Any two correct weak forms per sentence earn the point.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE STRESSED WORD

1 **red** · 2 **table** · 3 **I** · 4 **today** · 5 **say** · 6 **Marco**

In each case the tonic lands on the new or contrasted information: the word that carries the point of the sentence. In 4 the stress is on the second syllable: **toDAY**.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THOUGHT GROUPS

- 1 If you finish early / we can grab a coffee / before the train leaves.
- 2 Honestly / I'm not sure / but I think / it's worth a try.
- 3 If we can't agree on the budget by Friday / we'll have to postpone the launch. (Also fine: ...on the budget / by Friday / we'll have to...)
- 4 4a (non-defining): The report / which I sent yesterday / covers all three regions. 4b (defining): The report which I sent yesterday / covers all three regions.

4a vs 4b. In 4a there is only one report, and "which I sent yesterday" is extra information: the voice pauses before and after it, often on a slightly lower, quicker pitch, like a spoken pair of commas. In 4b the clause **identifies which report** (the one from yesterday, not another one), so there is no pause before *which*: the clause belongs in the same group as *the report*.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – STRESS THE NEW

1 at **SEVen** · 2 Room **FIVE** · 3 the **FIRST** half · 4 **toMORrow** · 5 **DALlas** · 6 **THAT's** my coffee

In 2, 4 and 5 the tonic is a **correction** (contrast with the speaker's wrong information). In 3 *first* is the contrast (and implies "but not the second half": a fall-rise works well). In 6 the contrast is *this vs that*, so the tonic moves right to the front. **Wrong:** 1 "IT leaves at seven" · 4 "I'm **WORKing** late tomorrow" (that information is given).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – INTONATION FOR ATTITUDE

Part A: 1 **falling** · 2 **rising** · 3 **fall-rise** · 4 **falling** · 5 **rising**. Note the trap in 4: many learners raise wh-questions, but English normally lets them fall.

Part B: 6 ↘ (a clear fall, often from a high start: enthusiasm) · 7 ↘↗ (reservation; a "but" is implied) · 8 ↘↗ (clean... but not quiet) · 9 ↘ (definite; a fall-rise would suggest a condition: "...but only in the morning")

◆ DIALOGUE – ONE SENTENCE, MANY MEANINGS

Alex stresses **I** to deny being the decision-maker and **MARcus** to name who was: contrastive stress shifts responsibility ("not me, him"). The fall-rise on "**FRIday** ↘↗... in theory" signals doubt: officially Friday, but Alex doesn't expect it to hold; a plain fall would sound like a firm yes. Sam's rise, rise, fall is the English list shape: the rises say "more is coming," and the fall says "that's the end, and I'm sure."

◆ SPEAKING – THE DELIVERY CLINIC

No single answer. When learners mark up their own summary, check that: the tonic is usually the last content word of each group unless something is contrasted; pauses come between clauses, before *but* / *and* / *because* and around inserted phrases, never after *the* or between a verb and its object; statements end with a fall. In the model recap, the contrast *OUT* vs *IN* and the fall-rise on "LONGest" (...but...) are the two moves learners most often miss.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

In the sentence "I'd like to book a table for two," which words should carry the main stress?

A) to, a, for

B) like, book, table, two

C) every word equally

Why: content words (verbs, nouns, numbers) carry the stress; function words (*to, a, for*) are weak. Equal stress (C) is syllable-timing, which makes English harder to follow.

Q2

You say "It's a great plan..." with a fall-rise (↘↗) on "plan." What are you signaling?

A) Total, enthusiastic agreement with no reservations

B) That you're asking a yes/no question

C) Reservation: an implied "but I have doubts"

Why: the fall-rise carries an unspoken "but." Enthusiasm would be a clear (often high) fall; a yes/no question would rise.

Q3 • new

"Did you send the report on Monday?" You sent it on Tuesday. Which reply puts the tonic in the right place?

A) "No, I SENT it on Tuesday."

B) "No, I sent the REPORT on Tuesday."

C) "No, I sent it on TUESday."

Why: the sending and the report are given information; the new, corrected information is the day. A suggests you did something else to it (not *sent*); B suggests you sent something else.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (7.2)

Equal stress on every syllable · strong, long *TO / OF / FOR / AND* · stress on the wrong syllable of a stressed word (*REsults, PROposal, DEvelopment* for *reSULTS, proPOSal, deVELOPMENT*) · pauses after *the* or in the middle of a phrase · rising statements, especially at the end of a presentation point · wh-questions with a rise · the fall-rise heard as sarcasm (usually a pitch range that's too wide or too slow) · *can* and *can't* both with a full vowel · no linking ("turn / it / off"). Praise range: a well-placed contrastive stress, a clean rise-rise-fall list, a fall-rise used diplomatically.

7.3 · SEMINAR & DISCUSSION SKILLS (C22)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – COMPLETE THE PHRASE

1 **in** · 2 **finish** · 3 **Building** · 4 **understand** · 5 **point** · 6 **leave**

Also accept 3 *Following* ("Following on from what you said..."). In 4, *understood* is wrong: the phrase is fixed as "if I understand you correctly."

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPLETE THE EXCHANGE

1 **finish** (holding the floor) · 2 **come in** (claiming a turn) · 3 **thoughts** (handing over) · 4 **correctly** (paraphrasing) · 5 **agree** (common ground) · 6 **move** (moving on)

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SOFTEN THE BLUNT DISAGREEMENT

Model rewrites (accept any version that acknowledges something specific, softens, and still makes the challenge clear):

- 1 I see the appeal of remote work, but I'd question whether productivity really holds up. Isn't there a risk that it drops over time?
- 2 I take your point, and I like the ambition, but I'm not sure how it would work in practice. Could we think through the logistics?
- 3 I agree we need to control costs, but I'd be cautious about cutting this particular budget. Up to a point, yes, but not here.
- 4 That's an interesting reading, but I'm not sure the text goes quite that far. Could we look at the second paragraph again?
- 5 You may well be right that most people type their notes now, but I'd question "nobody." Isn't there some evidence that handwriting helps some learners remember?

Not acceptable: rewrites that give up the view ("You're probably right, sorry") or a generic acknowledgment followed by the same bluntness ("Good point, but that's wrong"). The acknowledgment must name something.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – NAME THE MOVE

1 Dana	gives a view, then hands over by name ("What are your thoughts, Ben?")
2 Ben	builds on Dana's point ("Building on what you said"), adds evidence, and adds a new point ("To add to that")
3 Priya	comes in ("Could I just come in here?") + acknowledges and challenges ("I take your point about productivity, but I'd question whether...")
4 Dana	paraphrases to check ("So if I understand you correctly...")
5 Priya	confirms ("Exactly.")
6 Marco	comes in ("If I could just add something") + proposes + links two ideas ("That ties in with Priya's point")
7 Priya	partial agreement ("Up to a point, yes, but...") + soft challenge ("Isn't there a risk that...?")
8 Dana	acknowledges ("That's fair") + common ground ("Where we do agree, though, is...") + names the split
9 Marco	steers ("So where does that leave us?") + proposes a next step
10 Dana	summarizes ("So, to sum up...") + moves on ("Shall we move on to...?")

Why it never turns sour: every challenge is acknowledged and softened; each contribution builds on or links to the previous one; Dana paraphrases Priya's concern, which shows she has been heard; and Dana and Marco steer toward common ground and a decision instead of a winner.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – PARAPHRASE TO CHECK

- 1 So if I understand you correctly, you think phones are a problem in meetings, but a ban isn't the right solution ↗?
- 2 So your point is that portfolios are a fairer way to assess, but the grading workload is a real cost ↗?
- 3 So you're saying a car-free Main Street sounds attractive, but it could hurt the businesses that rely on passing drivers ↗?

A good paraphrase keeps **both halves** of the view and uses different words. **Weak:** repeating the sentence word for word; keeping only the half you disagree with ("So you're saying we should ban phones?"), which sounds like a trap. The rise matters: a falling paraphrase sounds like an accusation.

◆ SPEAKING – THE SEMINAR

No single answer. Check the observer sheets for the four target moves (come in, build on, paraphrase, respectful challenge) and the summarizer's two summaries. A good final summary has three parts: what the group broadly agrees on, where it is split, and a next step or open question ("So we broadly agree that..., but we're split on...; the open question is...").

Q1

A colleague is mid-sentence and you have something to add. What's the most appropriate way to take a turn?

A) "Sorry, could I just come in here?"

B) Start talking loudly over them until they stop.

C) Say nothing and let the moment pass.

Why: a coming-in phrase is a request that leaves the speaker a moment to yield. B is interrupting; C means your idea is never heard.

Q2

You strongly disagree with someone's proposal. Which opening keeps the disagreement constructive?

A) "No, that's completely wrong."

B) "I take your point, but I'm not sure we've thought through the cost..."

C) "Sure, whatever you think is best."

Why: B follows acknowledge → soften → challenge: firm on the idea, respectful to the person. A closes the discussion; C gives up the view entirely.

Q3 · new

You are the facilitator. Omar has spoken for three minutes; two people haven't spoken yet. What do you say?

A) "Omar, please stop talking now."

B) "Thanks, Omar, that's really useful. I'd love to hear from someone who hasn't come in yet. Lena?"

C) Nothing. The facilitator shouldn't interrupt.

Why: B thanks and credits Omar, then hands over by name, which is the facilitator's main job. A is accurate but face-threatening; C lets the discussion become a monologue.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (7.3)

"I am agree / I'm not agree" · "discuss about" · "According to me..." · "explain me" · "Can I say something?" used as a real stop sign in mid-flow without a softener · "I understand you correctly" (for *if I understand you correctly*) · a paraphrase that changes the speaker's view · generic acknowledgments ("Good point, but..." every time) · challengers who challenge only one side · a facilitator who never hands over · talking over others.

Appropriacy matters most here: praise the moves that kept the room warm (*That ties in with...*, *Up to a point, yes, but...*, *Where we do agree is...*).

Module 8 — Fluency, Craft & the Final Project: Answers

Answers to every Module 8 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the clean filler-free answer, the four 30% Cut Challenge texts, an annotated model position paper, poised defense answers), and the errors you can expect most.

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C1, mark **range, accuracy and appropriacy**. In this module many answers are open: a circumlocution, a repair or an edit is correct when it **works for the listener or reader**: it is clear, grammatical, keeps every idea, and suits the register. Accept any version that does this, even if it differs from the key, and use the key's version to show one more option ("Good. Another way is..."). For editing tasks, the three tests are always the same: **(1) no idea, number, name or source lost; (2) still grammatical (no headline-style dropping of articles or auxiliaries); (3) the register unchanged**. Contractions are fine. American English is the model; British spellings are acceptable when used consistently.

8.1 • FLUENCY & SPONTANEITY (C23)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – FREEZE OR FLOW? (SCRIPT 8.1-A)

Wall	What Speaker 2 says	Strategy
1 • hard question	"That's a good question. Let me think for a second..."	buying time
2 • missing word (<i>deadline</i>)	"...the, what's the word, the date when everything has to be finished"	circumlocution (situation / function)
3 • wrong detail	"...three projects, or rather, four, at the same time"	smooth repair

Discussion: neither speaker was faster. Speaker 2 sounds more fluent because there is no dead silence and no apology; every wall is filled with a phrase that carries meaning. Accept the gist of each quotation.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE STRATEGY PHRASE

- 1 it depends (a nuanced answer)
- 2 That's a good question (buying time on a hard one)

- 3 the thing you use to (paraphrasing *thermometer*)
- 4 or rather (a smooth correction)
- 5 what I mean is (restating more clearly)
- 6 Let me think (openly signaling thinking)
- 7 the person who (a role: *a lawyer / legal counsel*)
- 8 how can I put this (searching for careful wording)

Items 1–6 come from the online lesson. Accept *That's an interesting question* in 2 and *let me see* in 6. In 8, *it depends* would also be possible if 1 were answered differently; each phrase is used once.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – TALK AROUND IT (MODEL ANSWERS)

- 1 remote control: "It's the thing you use to change the channel without getting up." (function)
- 2 wardrobe: "It's a kind of tall cupboard where you hang your clothes." (category)
- 3 mechanic: "It's the person who fixes cars." (role)
- 4 umbrella: "It's like a small roof you carry, but it folds up." (comparison)
- 5 a receipt: "It's the piece of paper the store gives you to prove you paid." (function / thing)
- 6 a commute: "It's when you travel to work and back every day." (situation)
- 7 a landlord: "It's the person who owns the apartment you rent." (role)
- 8 a deadline: "It's the date when a piece of work has to be finished." (situation)

Accept any clear description; the task asks for a **different frame** each time, so check variety. **Weak answers:** a single word in another language; "a thing for clothes" (too vague: add category + function); a definition that uses the word itself ("a person who does mechanics").

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CLUMSY → SMOOTH

- 1 "The store opens at nine, or rather, ten."
- 2 "There were about fifty people, or should I say, closer to eighty."
- 3 "The new system is cheaper, or rather, what I mean is, it's faster."
- 4 "She's the manager of the, what's it called, the department that handles the company's money: finance."

Any repair phrase from the box is fine. Three things to check: **no "sorry," no restart, and the corrected information stressed.** In 4, accept "the finance department," "accounts," or a description alone ("the department that deals with money").

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE FILLER AUDIT (SCRIPT 8.1-B)

Tally: about 23 fillers: *so*, *um* ×4, *basically* ×2, *like* ×4, *you know* ×3, *sort of* ×2, *actually* ×2, *I mean* ×2, *and stuff*, *really*, *yeah*. Accept 18–25; the point is the ratio, not the exact number. **Worth keeping (max. two):** *I mean* before "not always" (it introduces a genuine clarification) and *actually* before "I miss my colleagues" (it signals a contrast with what came before). An opening *So* is also acceptable as a turn-starter.

Model clean version (about 30 words): "Working from home suits me, because I don't have to commute and I have more free time. But, actually, I miss my colleagues. Not all the time, I mean, but sometimes."

◆ DIALOGUE – MAYA'S STRATEGIES

T (buying time): that's a really good question · let me think for a second · well, it depends on how you look at it · how can I put this · bear with me a second · the way I see it. **C (circumlocution):** the whole system that checks whether information is accurate · the process you use to verify a source · a kind of... trust gap · what's the word (flagging the gap). **R (repair):** or rather, the lack of it · let me rephrase that · to put it another way. **M (markers with a job):** *hmm* · *you know* (shared understanding) · *I mean* (clarifying) · *sort of* a mixed picture (an honest hedge) · *essentially*. The online version says "the thing you use to verify a source"; the workbook uses "the process," which is more accurate for fact-checking; either is fine.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

At C1, the best definition of spoken fluency is:

A) speaking as fast as possible without pausing

B) keeping going coherently, even while you think

C) never pausing at any point

Why: fluency is continuity, not velocity. Filled pauses are normal; silent, frozen pauses and restarts break fluency. A and C describe the anxious "speed" goal the lesson replaces.

Q2

You can't remember the word "corkscrew" mid-sentence. The most fluent response is to:

A) stop and say "sorry, I don't know the word"

B) go silent until it comes to you

C) describe it: "the thing you use to open a wine bottle"

Why: circumlocution keeps the sentence moving and often prompts the listener to supply the word. A and B stop the conversation.

Q3 · new

Which is the smoothest self-correction?

A) "The meeting is on Thursday, or rather, Friday, so we have an extra day."

B) "The meeting is on Thursday. Sorry, sorry, no. Friday. Sorry."

C) "The meeting is on... I don't know how to say. Friday, I think."

Why: A repairs with *or rather* and continues the sentence. B apologizes three times and draws attention to the slip; C breaks the sentence and adds unnecessary uncertainty.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (8.1)

"Sorry, sorry..." at every repair · "How do you say..." + the L1 word · L1 fillers (*este, ěto, nàge, ya'ni, ano, nu, euh*) · "Actually" meaning "currently" · "That's a good question" before an easy question (sounds evasive) · stacked hedges on facts ("It's sort of, like, on Tuesday, kind of") · restarting the whole sentence after a small slip · speeding up after a time-buyer instead of slowing down. For range, praise *How can I put this?, Let me come at this from another angle*, precise paraphrases ("a device for measuring air pressure") and refinements (*or, more precisely...*).

8.2 · PRECISION & CONCISION (C24)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TIGHTEN THE WORDY PHRASE

1 **to** · 2 **because** (also *since, as*) · 3 **now** (also *currently*) · 4 **eliminate** · 5 **decide** · 6 **can** · 7 **crucial** (also *vital, essential, key*) · 8 **conclude** · 9 **although** (also *though, even though*) · 10 **soon**

Items 1–8 come from the online lesson. **Wrong:** 2 "due to" alone is possible before a noun (*due to the rain*) but not before a clause ("due to it rained" ✗) · 9 "despite" + clause ("despite the system is..." ✗).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CUT THE REDUNDANT WORD

1 **gift** · 2 **result** · 3 **history** · 4 **planning** · 5 **each or every** · 6 **proximity** (in practice, rewrite: *near, close to*) · 7 **outcome** · 8 **join**

The "why" in each case: the cut word repeats something already inside the other word (a gift is already free; an outcome is already final). In 5, *each and every* can be kept for deliberate emphasis in speech.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – UPGRADE, CUT, OR KEEP?

1 **exhausted** (also *worn out, drained*) · 2 **huge** (also *vast, enormous*) · 3 **astonished** (also *amazed, stunned*) · 4 **terrible** (also *severe, devastating*) · 5 **starving** (also *famished, ravenous*) · 6 **spotless** (also *immaculate*)

7 **CUT:** "It's a simple change." (four empty qualifiers) · 8 **KEEP:** real emphasis, a deliberate choice · 9 **KEEP:** *slightly* gives a precise degree · 10 **CUT:** "We were pleased with the excellent feedback." (or *delighted with the positive feedback*)

In 4, *devastating* is stronger than *really bad*; accept it if the context supports it. In 10, "quite really" is also ungrammatical stacking: point it out.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DIG OUT THE VERB

- 1 The committee will review the proposal.
- 2 We discussed the budget on Monday.
- 3 The manager explained the new policy.
- 4 The volunteers helped (assisted) the new families.
- 5 The council has improved the bus service.
- 6 We need to consider all the options before we decide.

Discussion question: the original of sentence 1 might suit a formal committee report or official minutes, where a nominal style sounds impersonal and procedural ("A review of the proposal will be carried out"). **Wrong:** "We discussed about the budget" (*discuss* takes a direct object) · "The manager explained us the policy."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – UNTANGLE IT

- 1 Delays are common when staff are absent. (online lesson answer)
- 2 Her proposal is similar to (like) the one we rejected last year.
- 3 The results may be roughly accurate. (online lesson answer; also: *The results may be broadly accurate.*)
- 4 A team was assembled to look into the matter raised at the last meeting. Its report was well received.

Item 3 has three negatives (*not impossible* · *not entirely* · *inaccurate*). Accept any version that keeps the tentative meaning; "The results were accurate" loses the hedge. In 4, accept other splits, e.g. "The team assembled after the last meeting wrote a report on the matter raised there. It was well received." Check that it really is two sentences, not a comma splice.

◆ DIALOGUE – IN THE EDITING ROOM

The four cuts: (1) a **wordy phrase**: *due to the fact that* → *because*; (2) **padding** removed: *we are currently at a point where*; (3) an **intensifier upgraded**: *very high* → *soaring*; (4) **buried verbs** dug out: *made the decision to* → *decided to*, *carry out a review of* → *review*. Word count: 29 → 11.

◆ WRITING – THE 30% CUT CHALLENGE (MODEL VERSIONS)

Models deliberately go past 30% to show what's possible; **any version at or below the target that keeps every idea is a success**. The ideas the meaning-keeper checks are printed on the back of each text card.

Text	Before → target	Model	Model version
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A · email	151 → ≤105	68 (-55%)	Dear all, We will soon change the front-desk schedule. Because many customers have complained about long early-morning waits, we have decided to review how shifts are organized. The busiest period seems to be 8 to 10 a.m., when only two people staff the desk. If you can start earlier on one or more days, please let me know. We will consider every suggestion carefully. Thanks in advance, Maria
B · newsletter	156 → ≤109	74 (-53%)	Many Eastside residents don't know that the community center on Park Street, renovated last year by volunteers from the residents' association, offers many free activities open to everyone. Besides the popular Saturday morning English conversation group, there are basic computer classes, a homework club for school-age children, and a repair café where volunteers fix broken items free of charge. For details, drop by during opening hours: 9 a.m. to 8 p.m., Monday through Saturday.
C · app	143 → ≤100	66 (-54%)	FocusFlow is a simple app that helps you manage your time. You can plan your day, and the app sends regular reminders so you don't forget your tasks. According to the developers' own research, people who use it daily for four weeks report feeling far less stressed and completing more tasks. The app is currently free, but a premium version with extra features is coming soon.
D · report	159 → ≤111	69 (-57%)	This section explains why teenagers often struggle to get up early. Many adults think teenagers are simply lazy. However, many studies have concluded that the body clock shifts during adolescence, so teenagers don't feel sleepy until about 11 p.m. or later. Because most high schools start early, many students attend lessons while their brains are still half asleep. This lack of sleep harms their concentration, mood and exam results.

Traps to watch for: A: cutting "8 to 10 a.m." or "one or more days" (facts); changing the register ("Hey guys"). B: cutting "renovated last year by volunteers" (an idea) or the opening hours. C: cutting "according to the developers' own research" (the **source** matters: that's critical reading, C1 6.1) or turning "report feeling" into "feel" (a claim becomes a fact). D: cutting "many adults think" (the view the paragraph argues against) or "or later." Good decisions **not** to cut: "seems to be" in A (a hedge), "report" in C, "Many adults think" in D.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which is the most concise rewrite of "We will make a decision at this point in time"?

A) We will decide now.

B) We will make a decision at the present time.

C) We will proceed in order to arrive at a decision now.

Why: A digs out the verb (*make a decision* → *decide*) and replaces *at this point in time* with *now*. B swaps one wordy phrase for another; C adds padding.

Q2

When is nominalization the right move rather than strong verbs?

A) When the genre calls for formal, impersonal abstraction: match the tool to the goal

B) Never: strong verbs are always better than nouns

C) Always: nominalization is more correct than plain verbs

Why: neither style is "correct" in the abstract. Nominalization (C1 3.1) suits reports and legal texts; strong verbs suit emails, summaries and arguments. The writer chooses for the reader and purpose.

Q3 · new

Best edit of "Due to the fact that a large number of staff were absent, we made the decision to postpone the review"?

A) Due to many staff being absent, a decision was made to postpone.

B) Staff absent, review postponed.

C) Because many staff were absent, we postponed the review.

Why: C makes all three cuts (*because*, *many*, *postponed*) and keeps every idea. A keeps a nominal, passive structure and loses "the review." B is headline style: articles and verbs are gone, so it is no longer a normal sentence (over-cutting).

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE MOST (8.2)

Over-cutting (articles, auxiliaries and *that* dropped: "Committee will review proposal") · cutting a **number, name or source** · cutting a **hedge** and turning a claim into a fact ("seems to be" → "is") · changing the register (an email becomes a text message) · "due to" + clause · "despite" + clause · "discuss about" · comma splices after "splitting" a sentence · replacing *very* + *adjective* with a word of the wrong strength (*very good* → "perfect"). For range, praise precise strong words (*soaring, spotless, drained*), sensible decisions *not* to cut, and varied sentence length.

8.3 · A POSITION PAPER & ITS DEFENSE (C25)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO A DEFENSE (SCRIPT 8.3-A)

- 1 That city centers should be closed to private cars.
- 2 That such a ban would hurt local businesses. She answers with evidence: foot traffic on car-free streets tends to rise, not fall.
- 3 She concedes that a blanket ban would be unfair, then clarifies that her proposal exempts accessible transportation and permit holders, so the principle stands if the exemptions are well designed.
- 4 Whether the rise in foot traffic only happens in wealthy cities that could already afford good public transportation.
- 5 She hedges it: the effect is clearest where transportation is strong, the causation may run both ways, and the ban works best **alongside** investment in transportation, not instead of it.
- 6 She checks the question ("If I've understood your question, you're asking..."), concedes she can't be certain, and proposes a trial period with a review after a year.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – THE MODEL PAPER

(a) **Parts:** ¶1 = 1 thesis · ¶2 = 2 argument A (health) · ¶3 = 3 argument B (learning, + equity) · ¶4 = 4 counter-argument · ¶5 = 5 rebuttal · ¶6 = 6 conclusion.

(b) **Hedges** (any three): *broadly agree* · *up to two hours* · *generally reported* · *some studies suggest modest gains* · *hardly surprising* · *typically* · *often* · *may be unable* · *would appear to offer*.

(c) **Tools:** participle clause: *Given this shift, ...* · inversion: *Not only would a later start protect...* · *Rarely does a single decision promise...* · *Nor would the benefit be evenly spread* · conditional: *Were the school day aligned..., teachers would spend...* (inverted conditional) · cleft / fronting: *It is for this reason that...* · *it is typically students with the longest commutes... who lose the most sleep* · academic collocations: *chronic sleep loss* · *well documented* · *modest gains* · *a related consideration* · *practical rather than fundamental* · *the weight of evidence* · *a rare combination of low cost and high return*. Also: nominalization and reference (*These concerns, ... the change*) and concession (*Admittedly, it might be objected that...*). About 480 words + title.

Examiner questions (good examples): "You say some studies suggest gains in grades. How strong and how consistent is that evidence?" · "Wouldn't later finishing times simply move the problem to the evening, when students do homework and jobs?" · "Why 9 a.m. rather than the 8:30 the pediatric organizations recommend?" · "What would change your mind?"

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE THESIS TEST

1 ✓ arguable, clear and specific · 2 ✗ a fact · 3 ✗ a survey, not a position · 4 ✗ too vague (and over-hedged) · 5 ✗ an outburst (attacks people, no reason) · 6 ✓ arguable, clear and specific

Model rewrites: 3 → "This paper argues that homework for children under ten should be limited to reading." · 4 → "This paper argues that high schools should teach every student to evaluate online sources critically." · 5 → "This paper argues that stores should continue to accept cash, because going cashless excludes customers without bank cards." Accept any rewrite that is arguable, clear and specific.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MIXED C1 REVIEW

1 **Given** · 2 **to** · 3 **suggests** (also *indicates, shows*) · 4 **however** (also *nevertheless, even so*) · 5 **appear** (also *seem*) · 6 **but** · 7 **Were** · 8 **What** · 9 **Because** (also *Since, As*) · 10 **decide**

Items 1–6 and 9–10 come from the online lesson (Exercises 1 and 2). 7 is the inverted conditional (C1 2.1–2.2); 8 is a *wh*-cleft (C1 2.3). **Wrong:** 2 "threat for" · 4 "on the other side" · 6 "but also" is also correct (*but it is also*) · 7 "If" alone doesn't fit ("If the plan adopted" ✗).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CONCEDE WITHOUT COLLAPSING

1 **B** · 2 **A** · 3 **C**

In each set, one response **collapses** (1A, 2C, 3B: it abandons the case), one **stonewalls** (1C, 2B, 3A: no concession, no reason) and one is **poised** (concede → hold → reason). 2A is a model of hedging a claim rather than defending it at all costs. **Own answer:** look for a named objection, a genuine concession and a reason for holding the position; accept any topic.

◆ PLANNING FRAME, CHECKLIST, DEFENSE PREP, RUBRIC

Open tasks: no key. When you check planning frames (C24) and papers (after C25), use the **paper rubric** (materials set J). The two most common planning problems: a thesis that is a **survey** ("There are advantages and disadvantages...") and an objection that is a **straw man** ("Some people think children should never sleep"). Ask one question for each rather than rewriting it: "Would someone on the other side really say that? What would they actually say?"

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

What single element most distinguishes a position paper from a simple opinion essay?

A) It is much longer and more detailed.

B) It stays neutral and presents every view equally.

C) It acknowledges a counter-argument and rebuts it.

Why: the concede-then-rebut move shows the writer has weighed the question. Length isn't the point (position papers are often short), and neutrality makes it a survey, not a position.

Q2

Someone raises a genuinely fair objection to your case. The most advanced response is to:

A) refuse to concede anything and restate your thesis more loudly

B) concede the fair point, then explain why your position still holds

C) immediately abandon your position and agree

Why: honest concession plus a reasoned "and yet" is the poised middle. A stonewalls; C collapses.

Q3 • new

You're not sure what exactly an examiner means. Which is the best start?

A) "Sorry, I don't understand. Next question, please."

B) "If I've understood your question, you're asking whether the evidence applies to smaller cities. To some extent, yes; however..."

C) Answer a different question that you prepared at home.

Why: B checks the question, buys a few seconds, and lets the examiner correct you before you answer. A refuses the question; C ignores it (examiners notice immediately).

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR AND SEE MOST (8.3)

In papers: a survey instead of a thesis · the thesis in the last paragraph · a straw-man objection · overclaiming ("This proves that...", "Everyone agrees...") · "According to me" / "In my opinion, I think" · "discuss about," "emphasize on," "explain me" · toolkit items forced in where they don't fit (three inversions in one paragraph) · mixed American and British spelling. **In the defense:** reading the paper aloud · answering the question they prepared instead of the one asked · collapsing ("You're right, my idea is bad") or stonewalling ("No, that's wrong") · "I am agree with you" · long silences before a hard answer. For range, praise genuine concessions, refined claims (*So I'd put it more cautiously...*), checking questions, and examiners' precise follow-ups.